

Introduction to Archaeology at Monticello

Fraser D. Neiman



The Plan

- Introduction to the course
- Requirements and evaluation
- Introductions
- Lecture: *Introduction to Archaeology at Monticello.*
- Walking Seminar: *The Monticello Plantation Home-Farm Landscape: Site 7, 8, 6 and 30.*
- Lunch
- Workshop: *Fieldwork Basics*



1. These houses No. 1 & 2 of No.

2. Nelson, Fassett Walker, Rising plan No. 2. This will
 1st. be on the corner, 20 ft. from the corner.

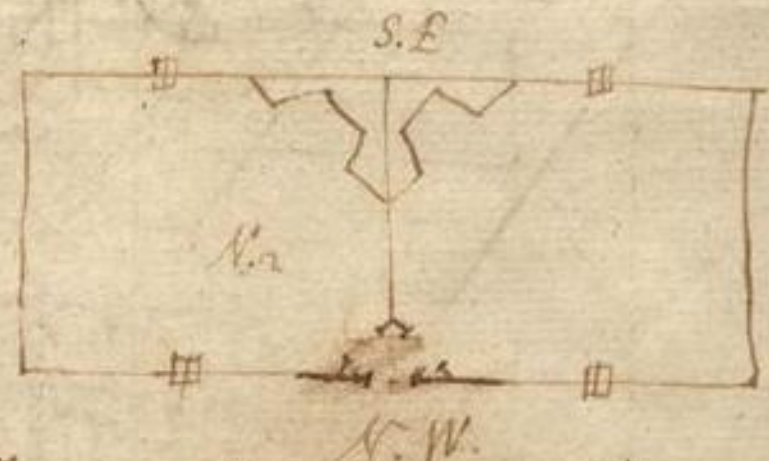
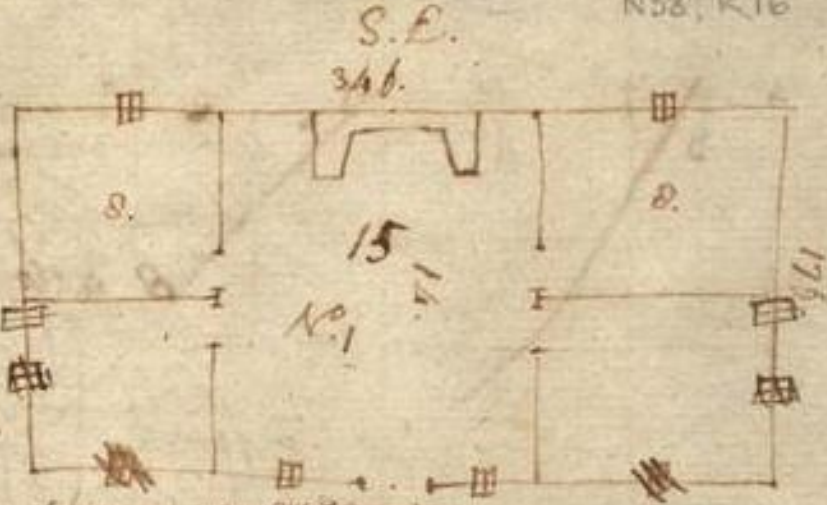
3. for the corner, plan No. 1.

4. for Betty Heming, plan No. 1.

5. for Betty & George, plan No. 2.

1. S. Ward range, with 2 W. end on chambers, for the house NE corner at highway, 20 ft. from the corner.
 2. S. Ward range, with 2 W. end on chambers, for the house NE corner at highway, 20 ft. from the corner.
 3. S. Ward range, with 2 W. end on chambers, for the house NE corner at highway, 20 ft. from the corner.
 4. S. Ward range, with 2 W. end on chambers, for the house NE corner at highway, 20 ft. from the corner.
 5. S. Ward range, with 2 W. end on chambers, for the house NE corner at highway, 20 ft. from the corner.

6. plan No. 1. House. Dinah
 7. plan No. 1. House. Dinah

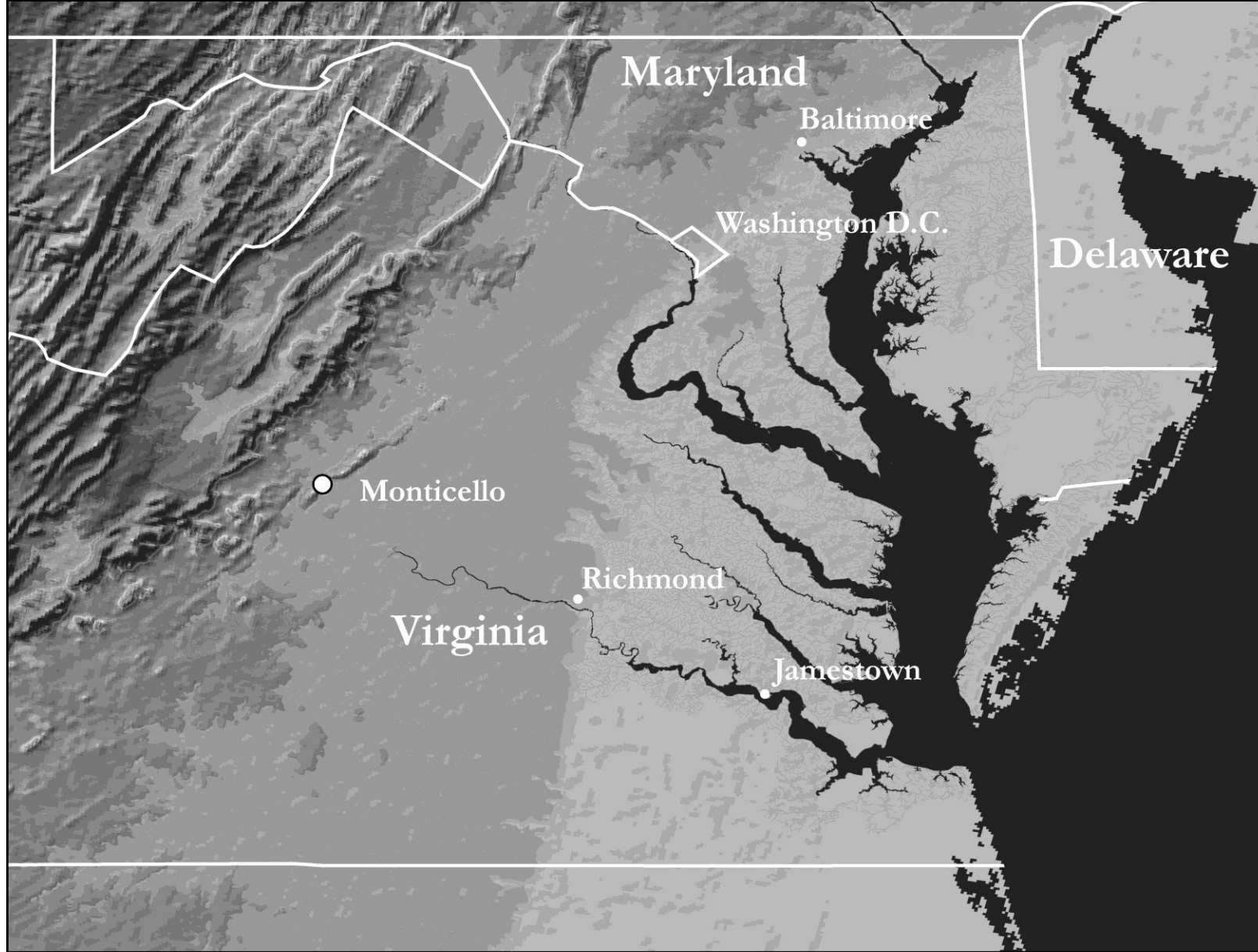


The front of these houses to be 18 ft. below the upper edge of the Roundabout, making the N.E. end of the 2nd house (the corner of the S. side) the S.W. end of the bent house ramp with the S.W. end of the bent house, they will be 18 ft. from the center to center.

*The upper end of the 2nd house to be 18 ft. below the upper edge of the Roundabout.



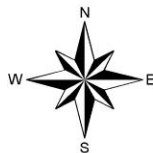




0 50 100 Miles

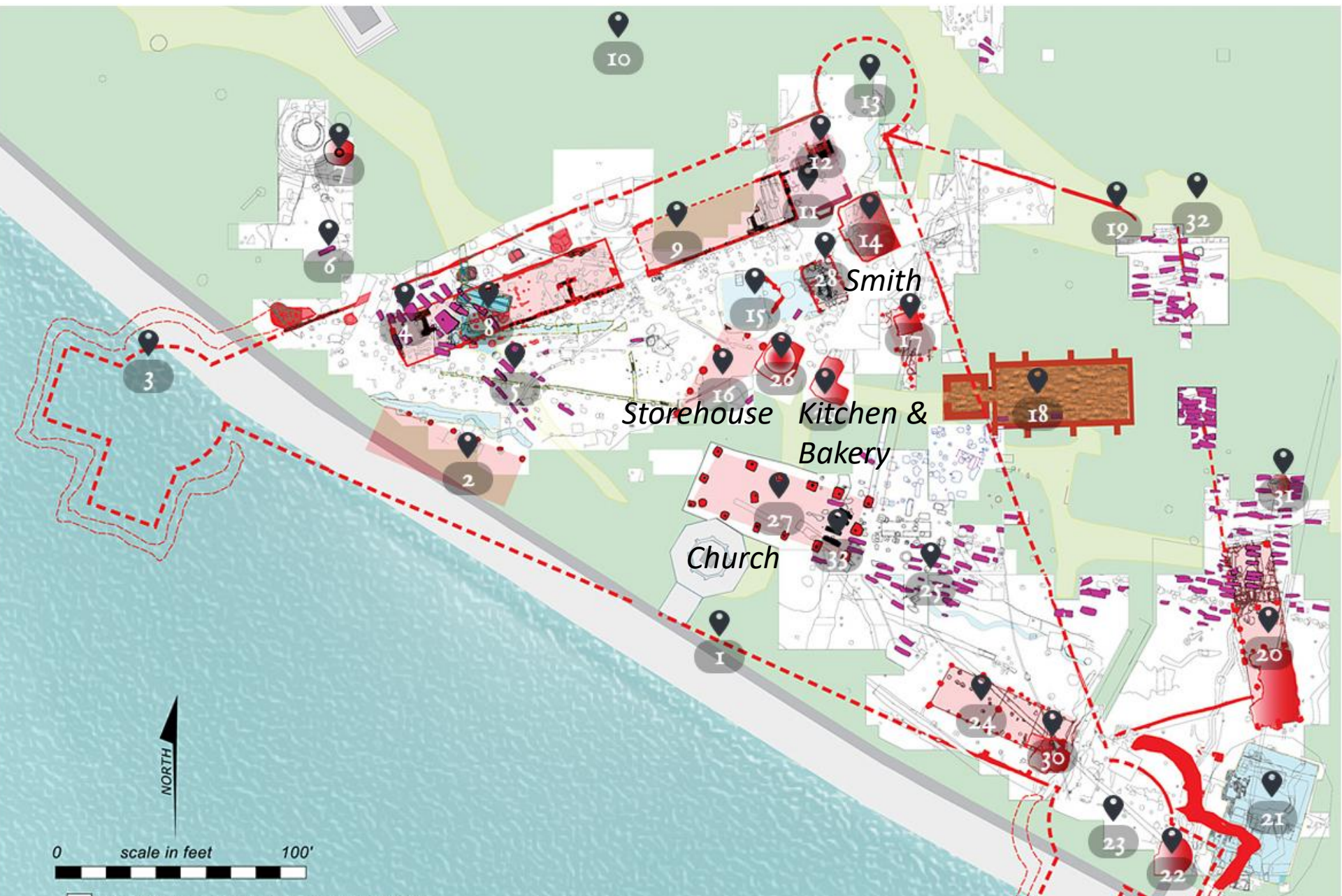


0 100 200 Kilometers



James Fort: 1607

Corporate Settlement



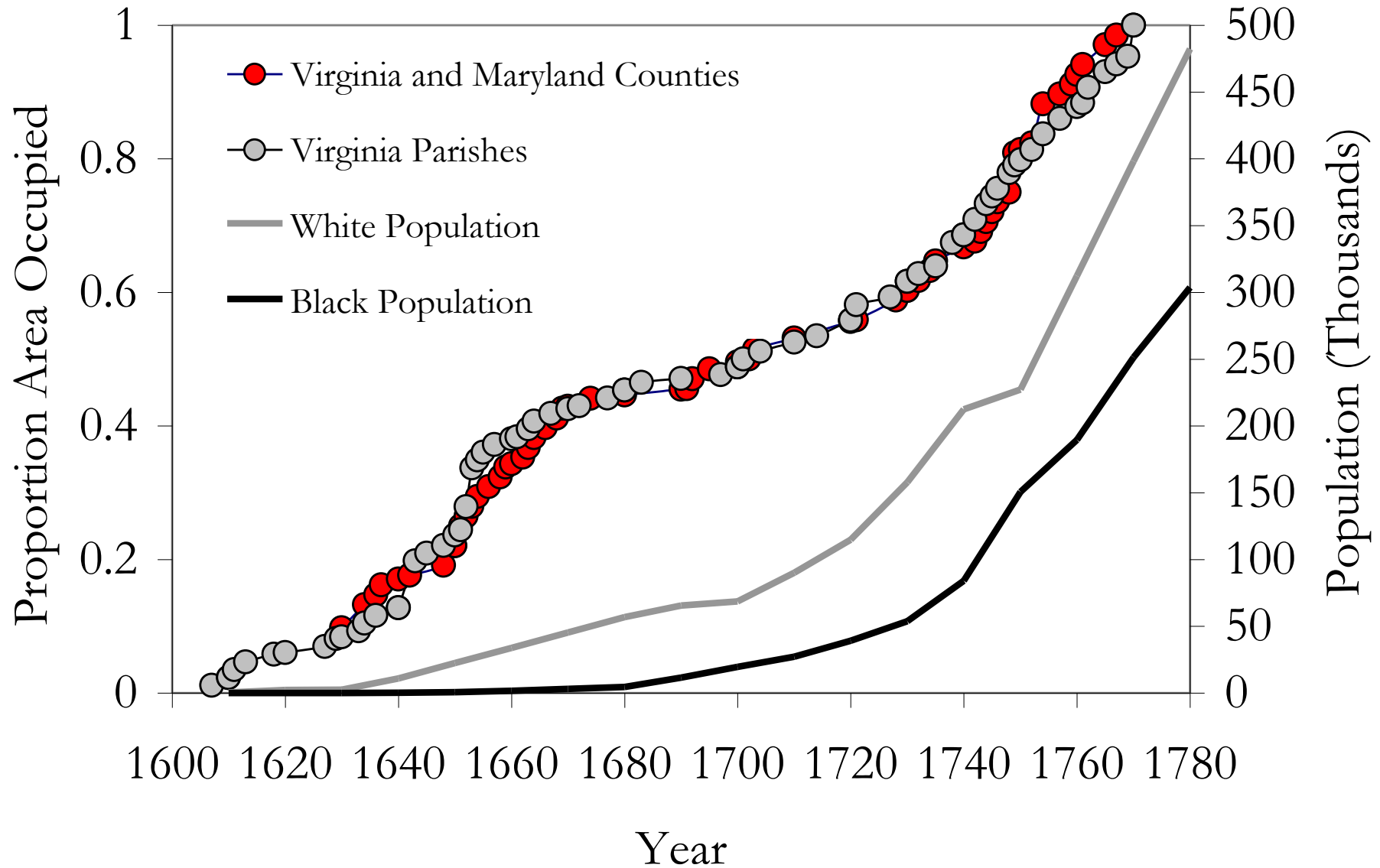


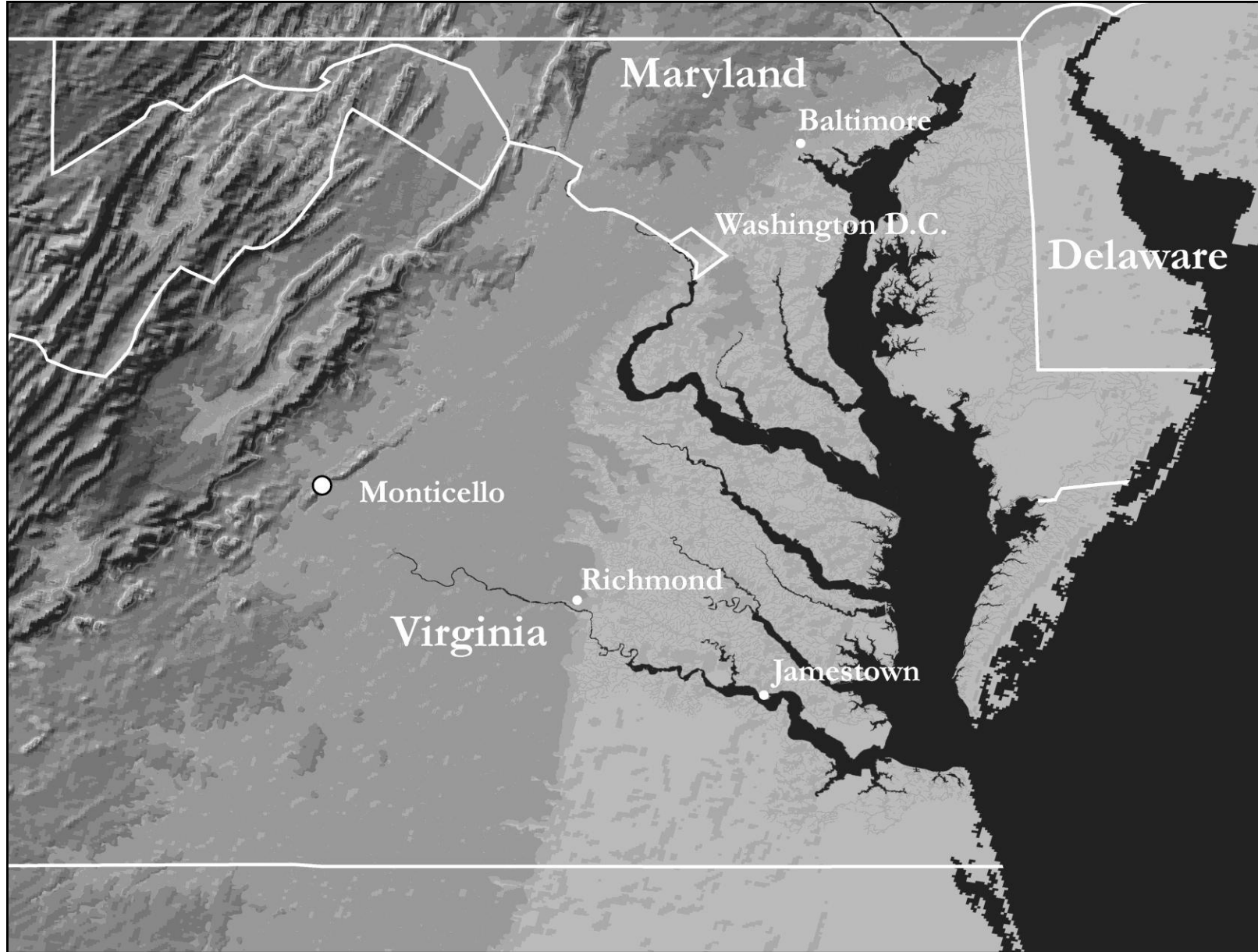
Household Settlement

- Tobacco
- Swidden Agriculture
- Indentured Servitude
- English victories in the Anglo-Powhatan Wars (1610-14, 1622-26, 1644-46)



Demographic Expansion across the Chesapeake

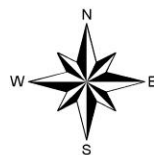




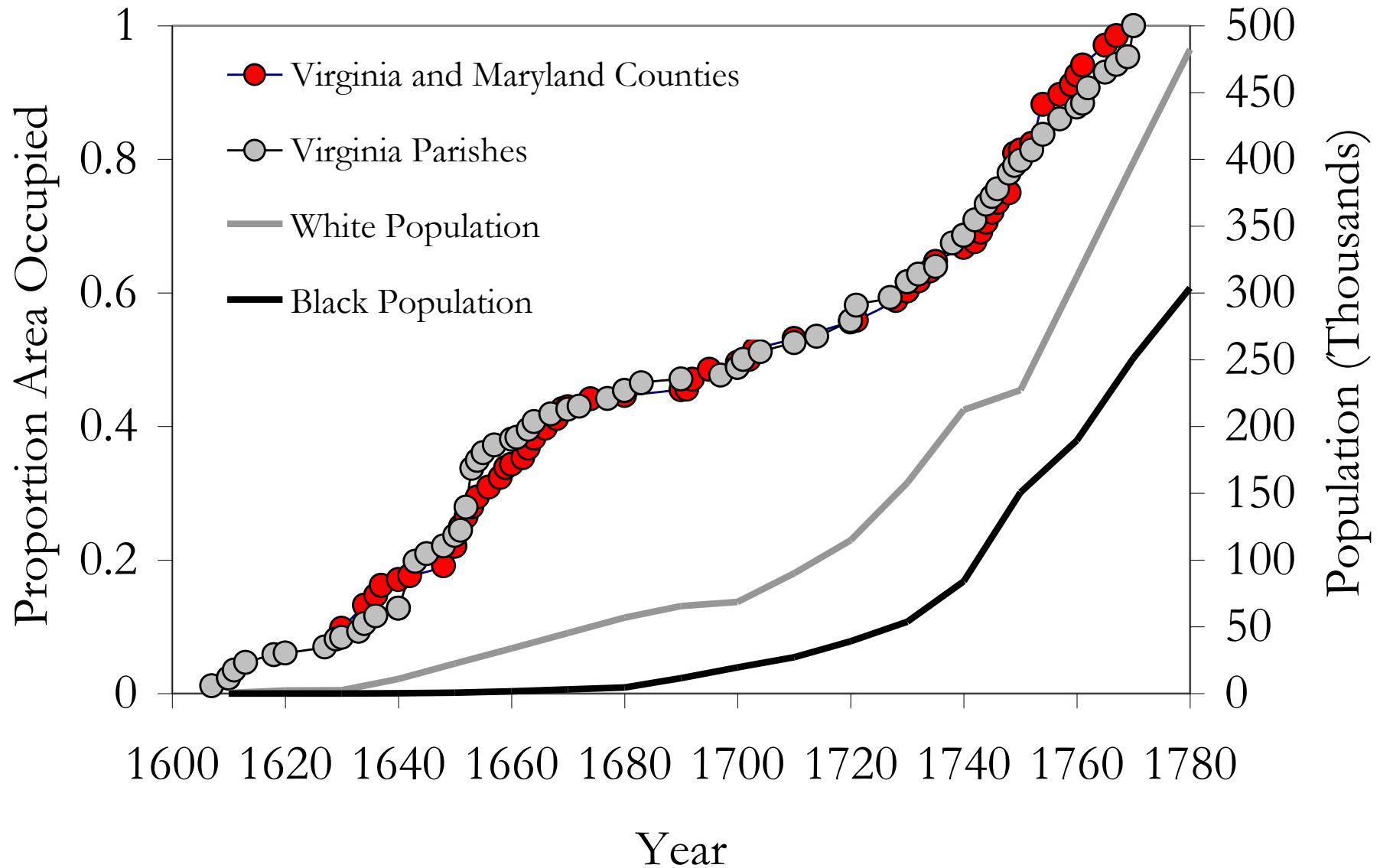
0 50 100 Miles



0 100 200 Kilometers



Demographic Expansion across the Chesapeake





VIRGINIA

CAROLINA

MARYLAND

NE

P.R.S.

Y.L.A.

N.D.

T.H.E. NORTHERN

S.E.A.

NEW JARVIS

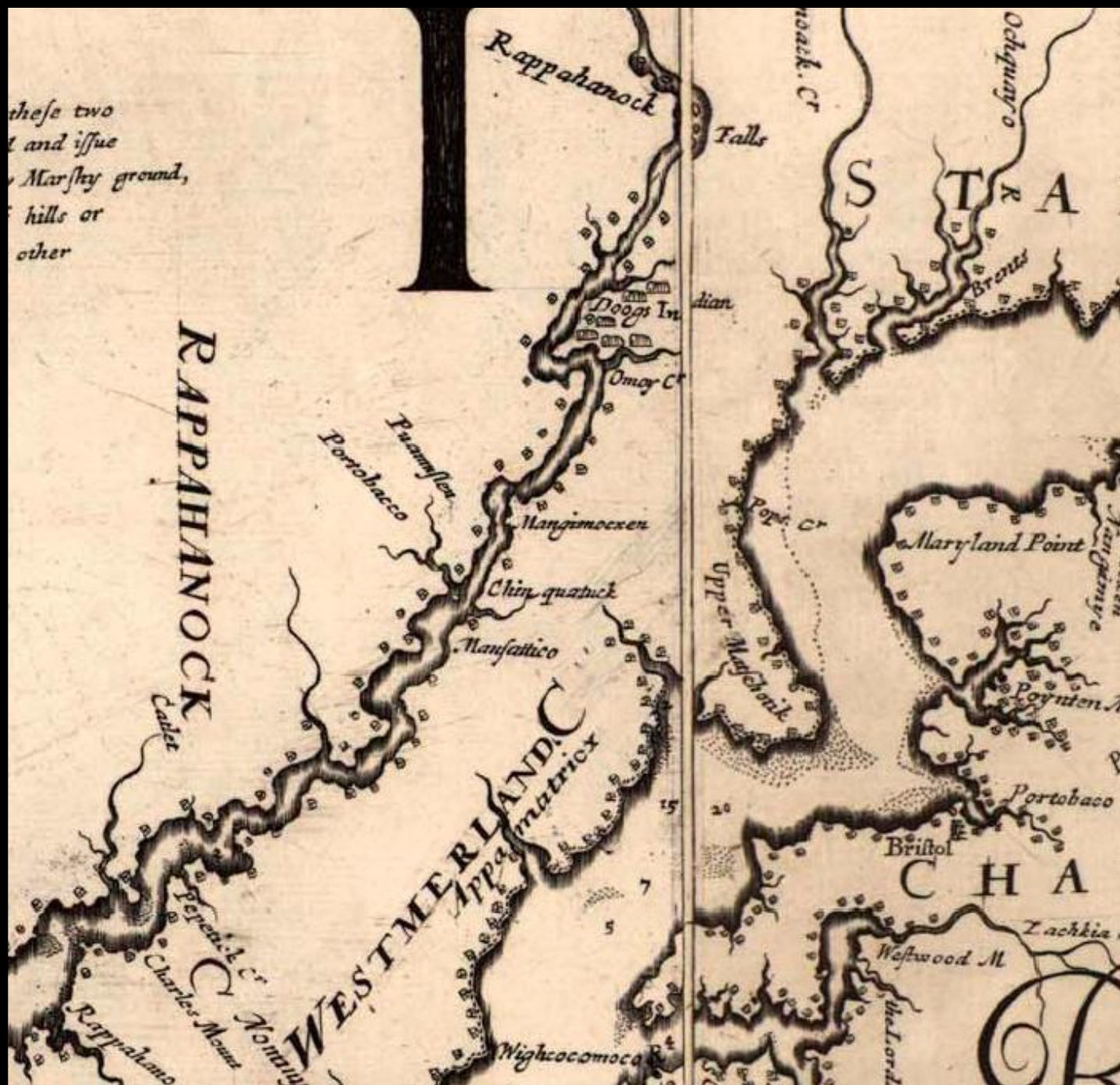
P.A.R.S.



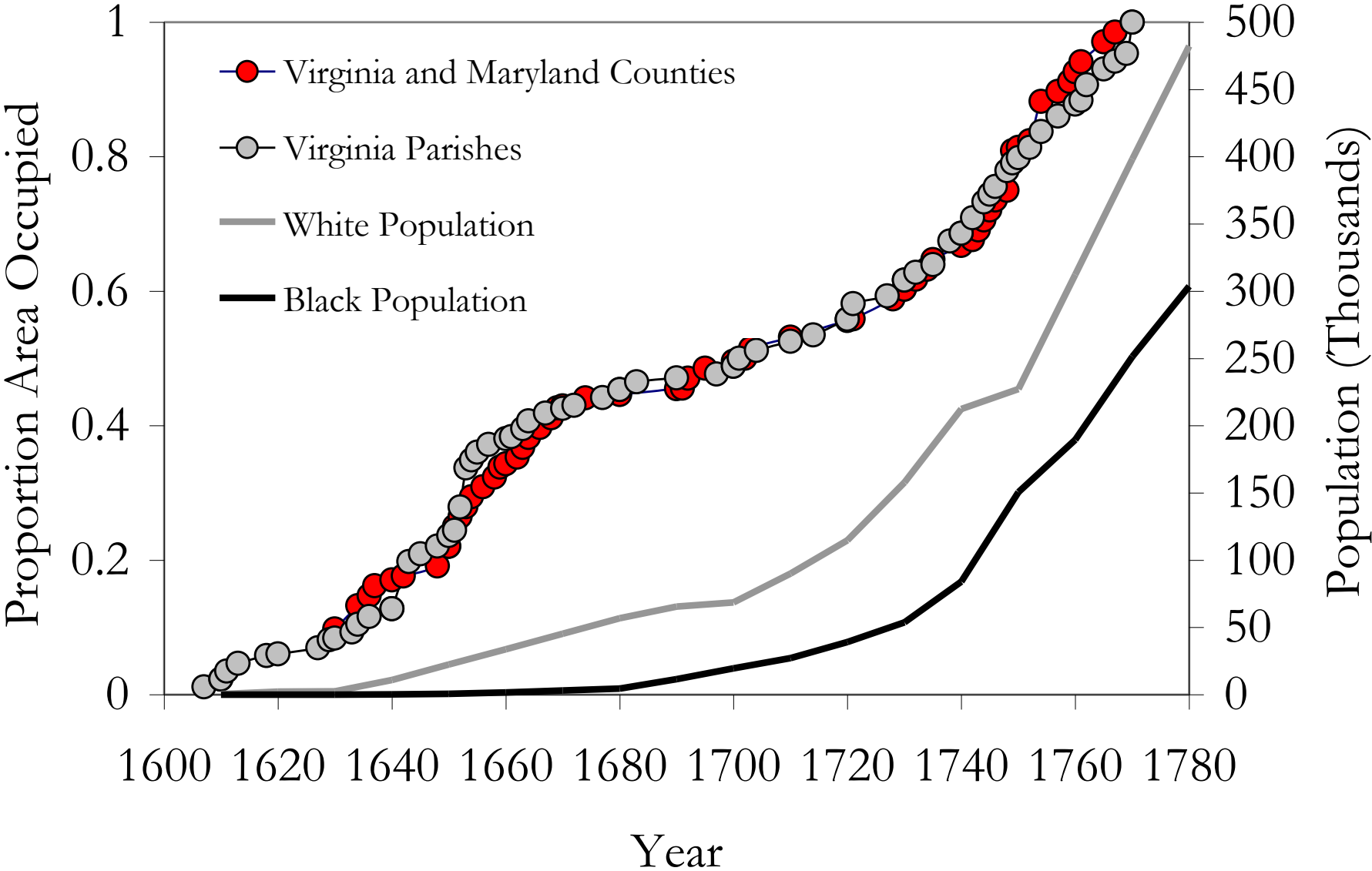
Published by Authority of the Right
Honorable and Excellent Prince of Wales
at his Highness's Chamber, in the Strand
in the Year 1693. Price 1s. 6d.

W. Baskin del.

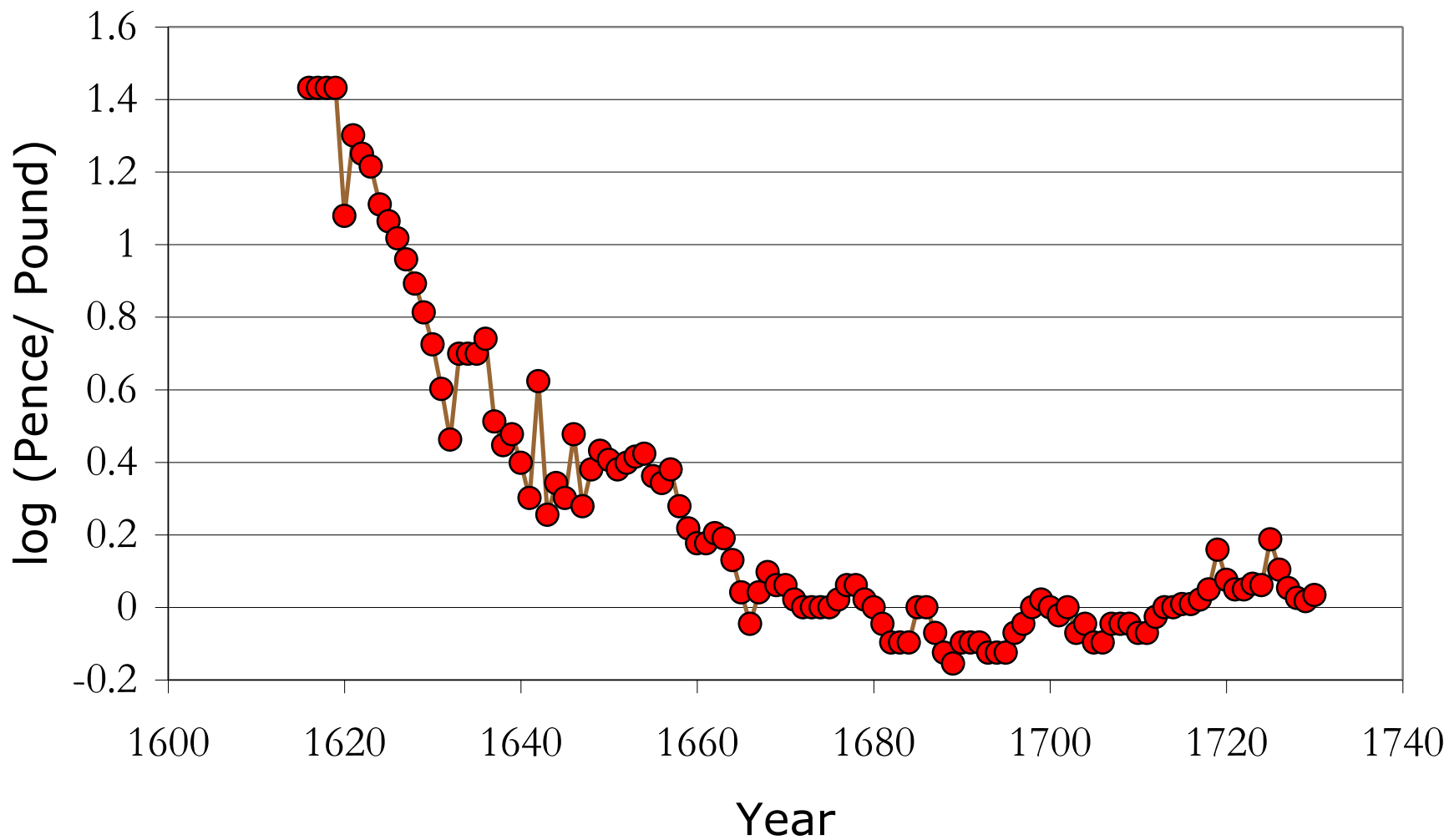
these two
and issue
Marshy ground,
hills or
other



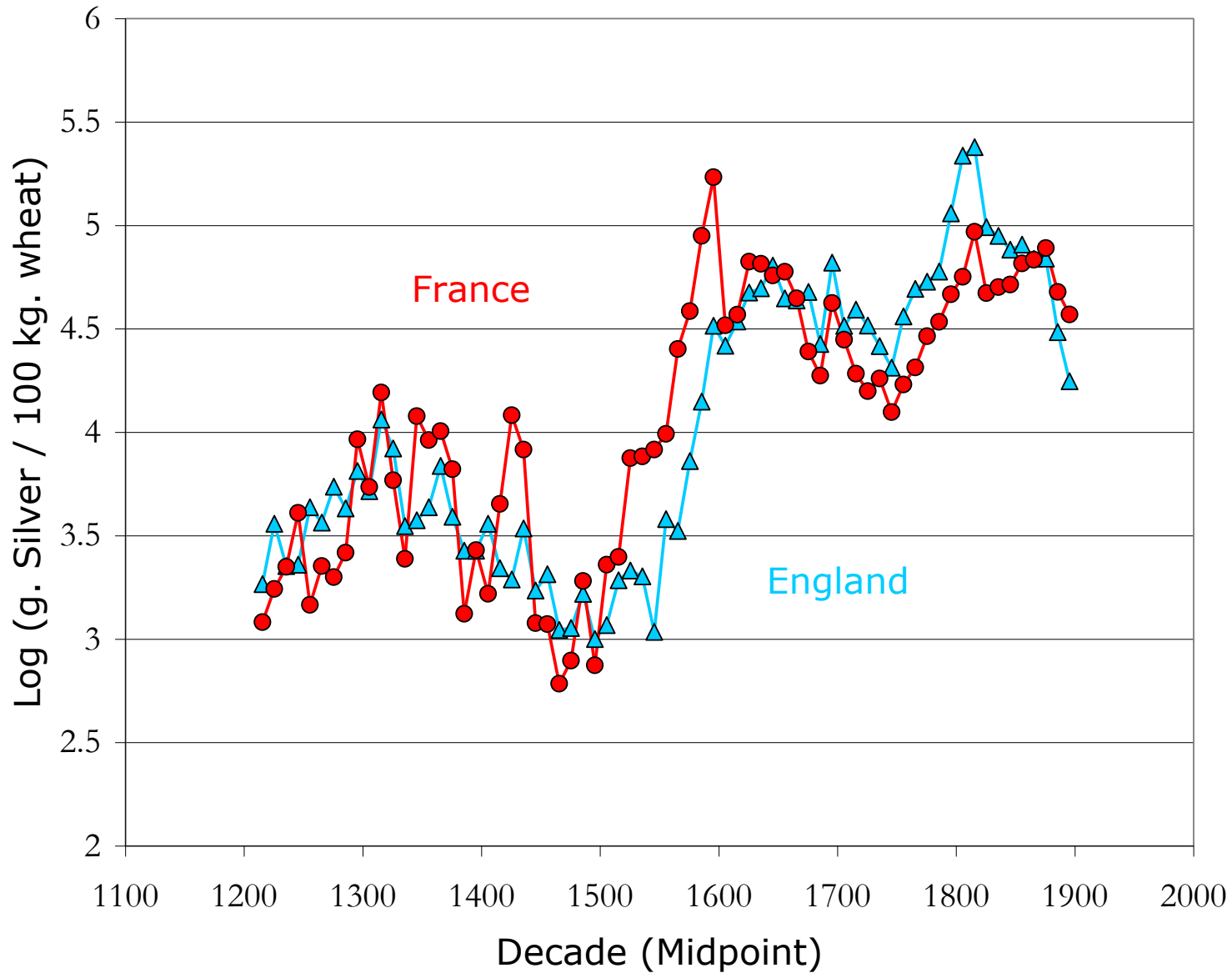
Demographic Expansion

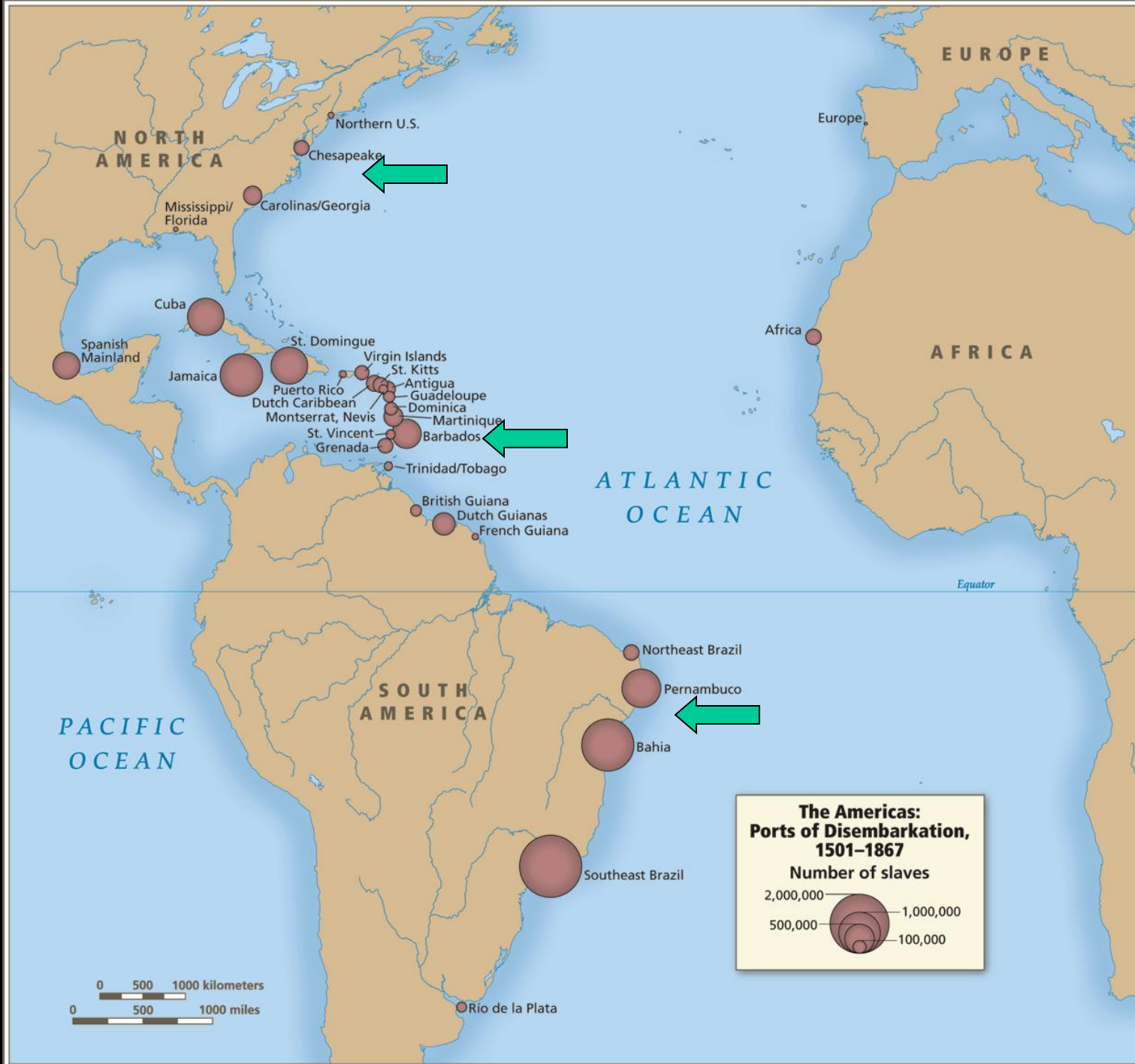


Chesapeake Tobacco Prices

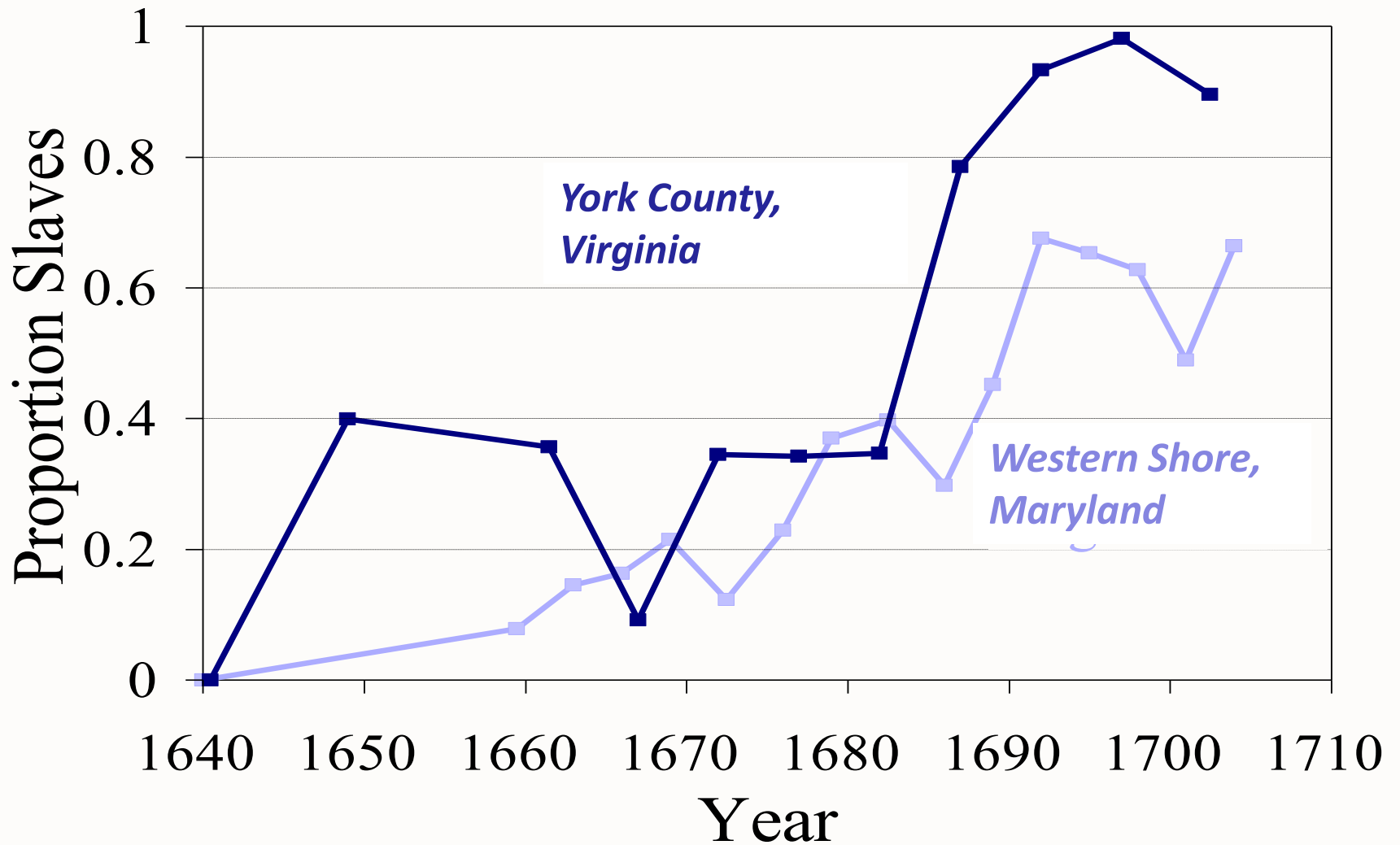


European Wheat Prices





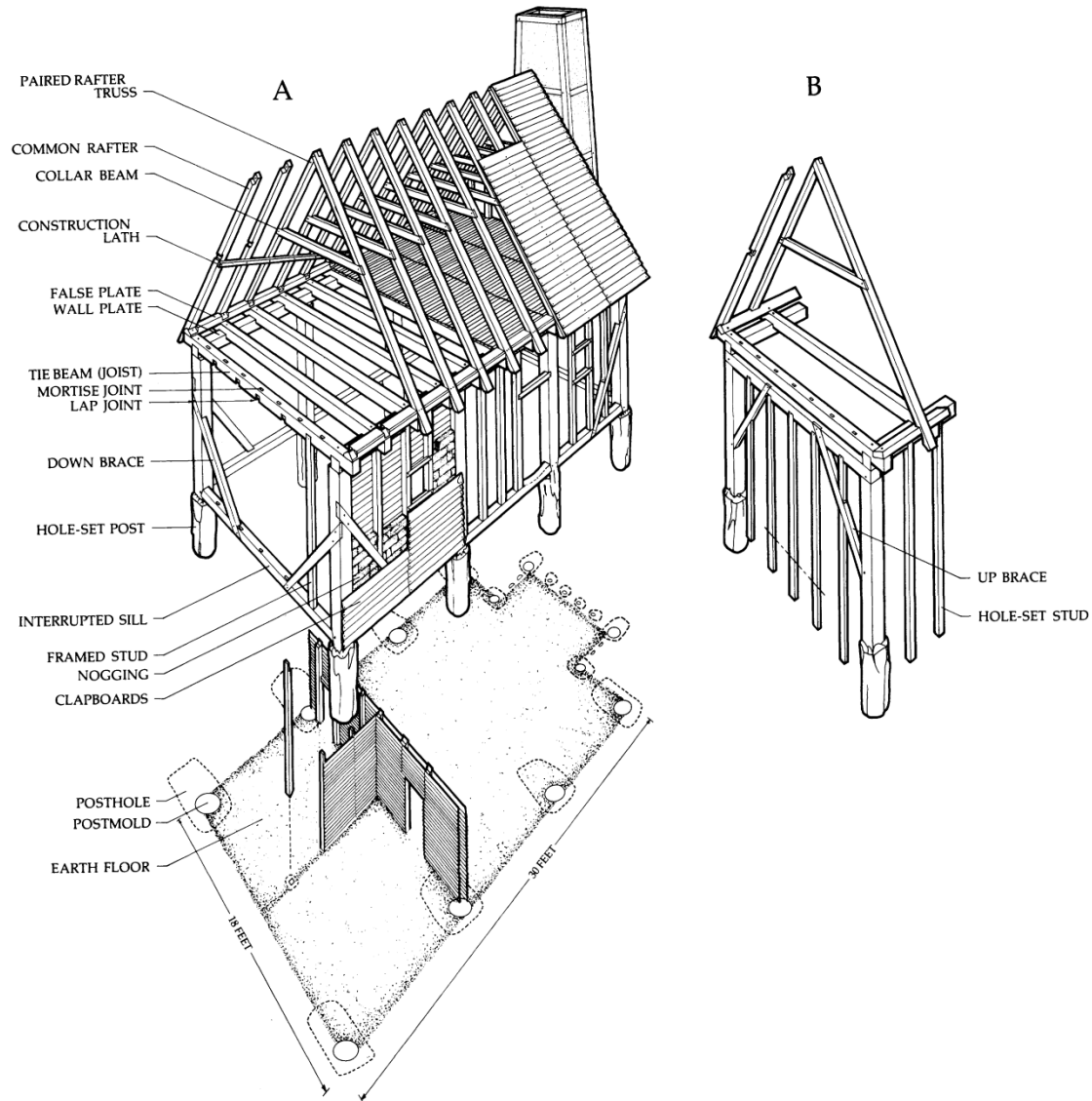
Transition to Slavery in the Chesapeake





Architectural Technology

Earthfast Technology





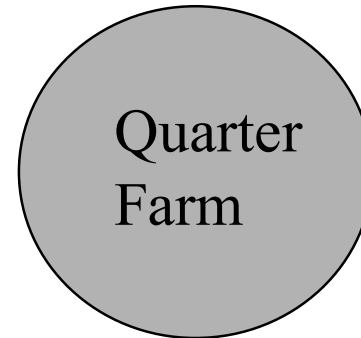
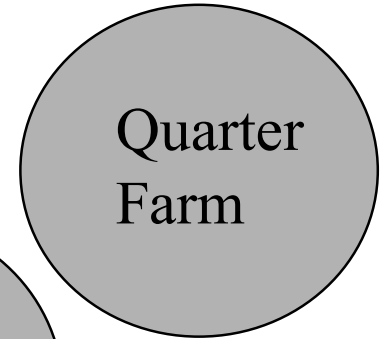
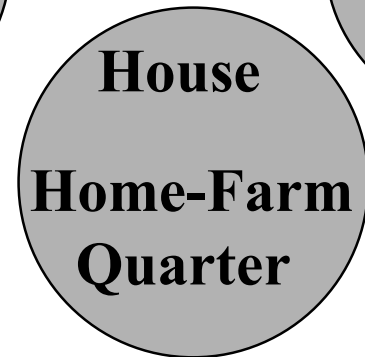
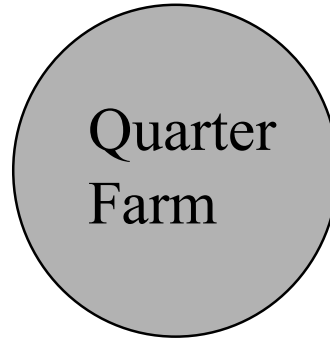


Plantation Spatial Organization

Quarter Farms



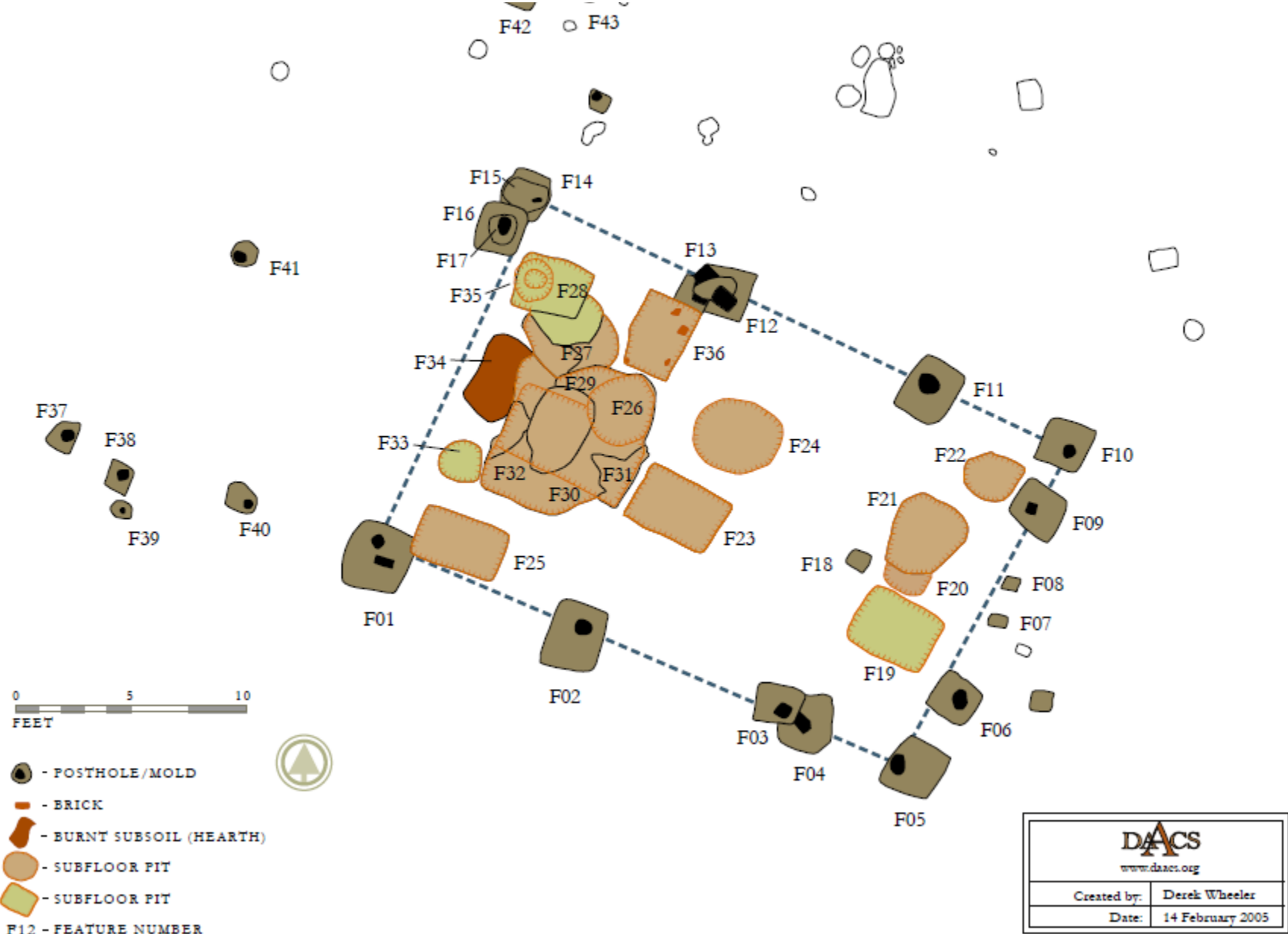
17th Century



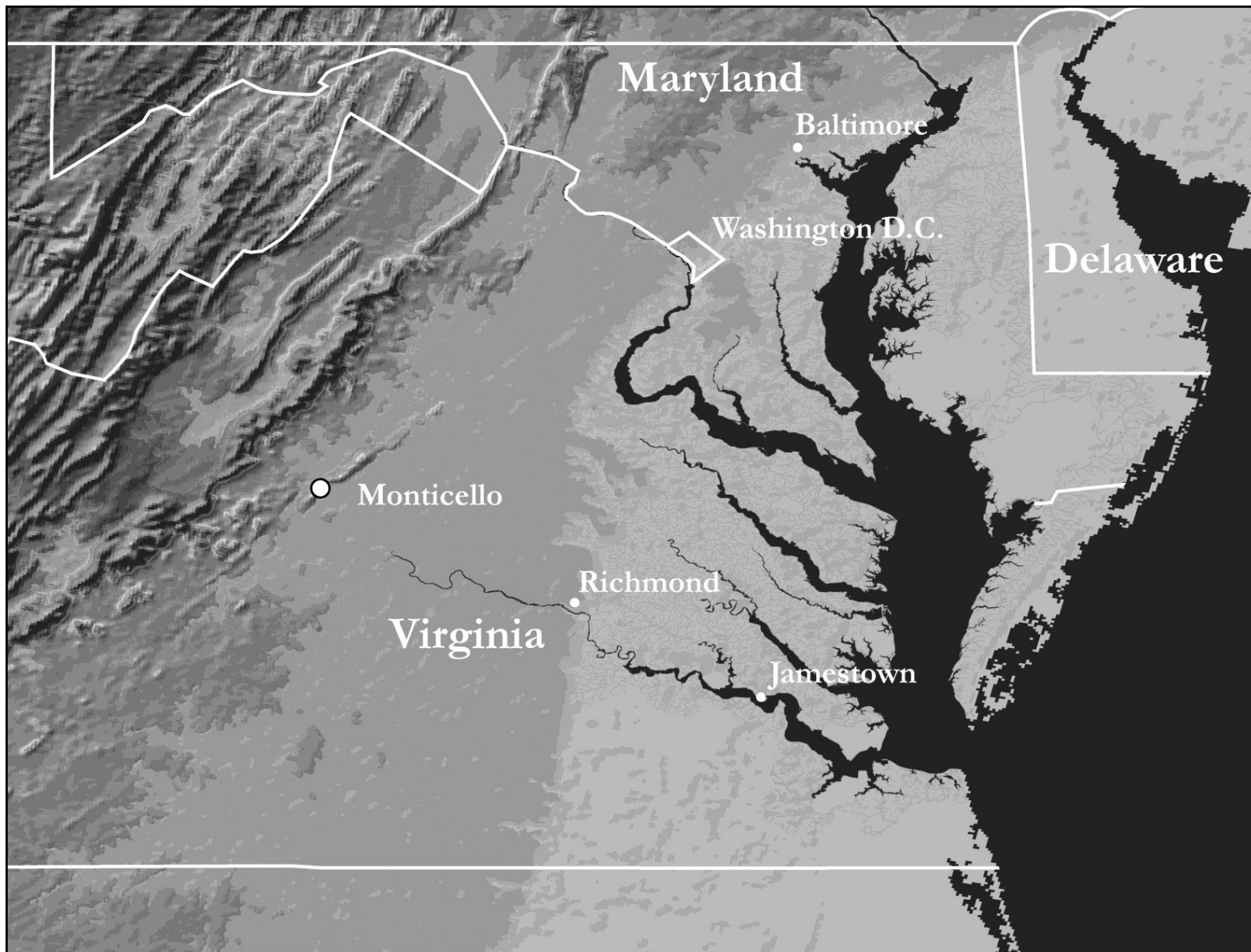
18th Century

Laborer Housing

Multiple Small Cellars: Subfloor Pits





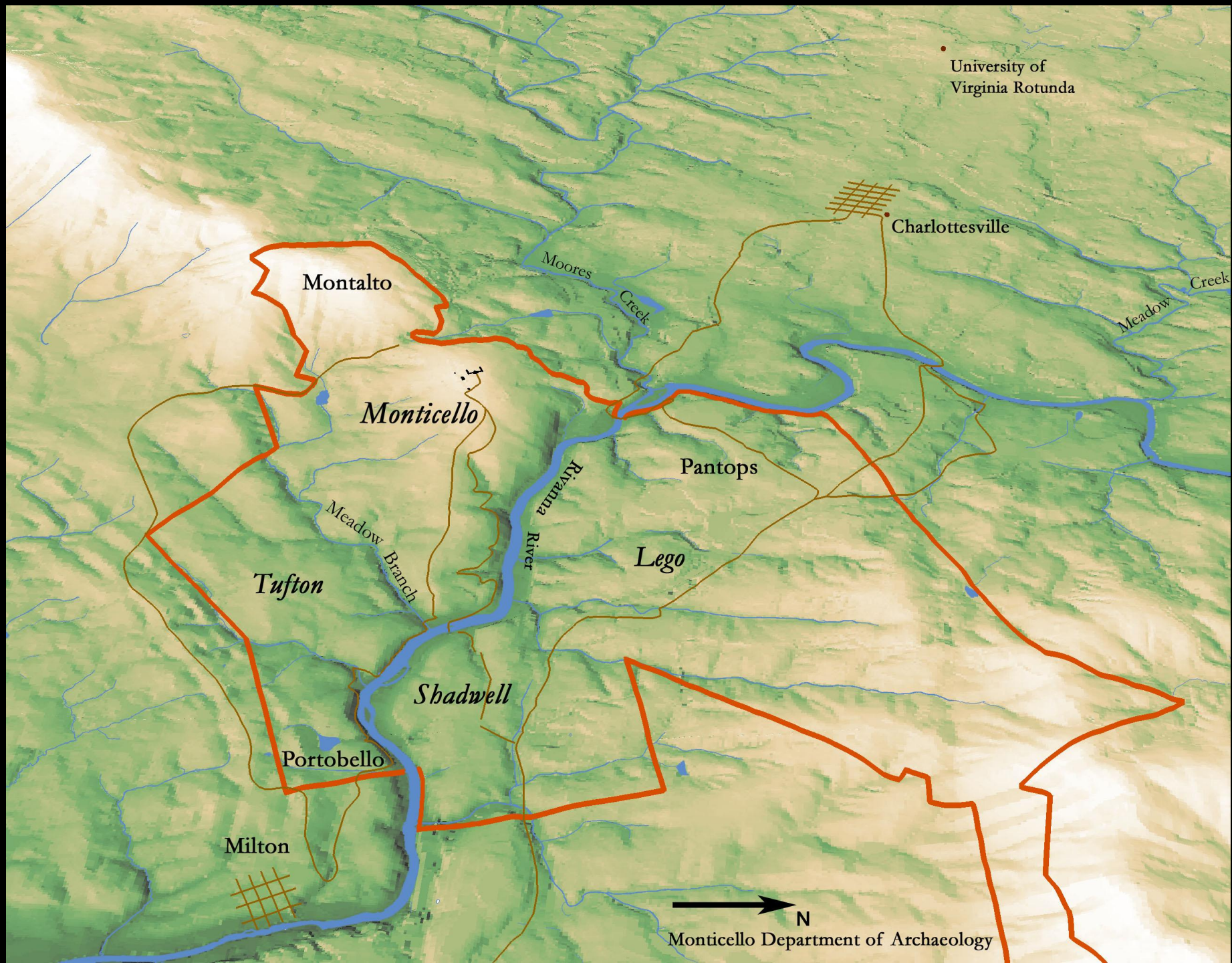


0 50 100 Miles



0 100 200 Kilometers







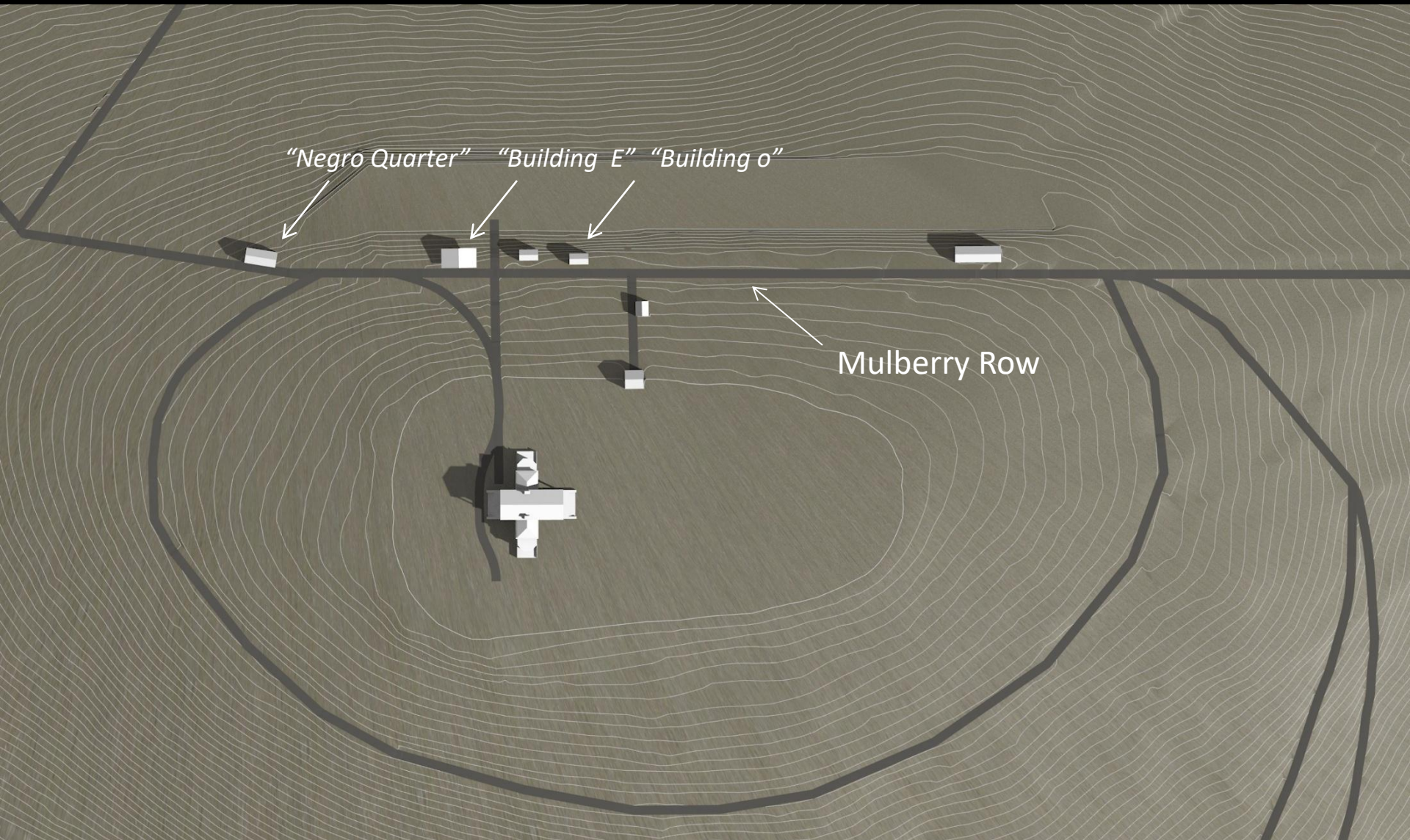
Monticello I:
c. 1770-1796



Monticello II:
c. 1796 -



Mulberry Row, c.1770-1789





Soil Horizons

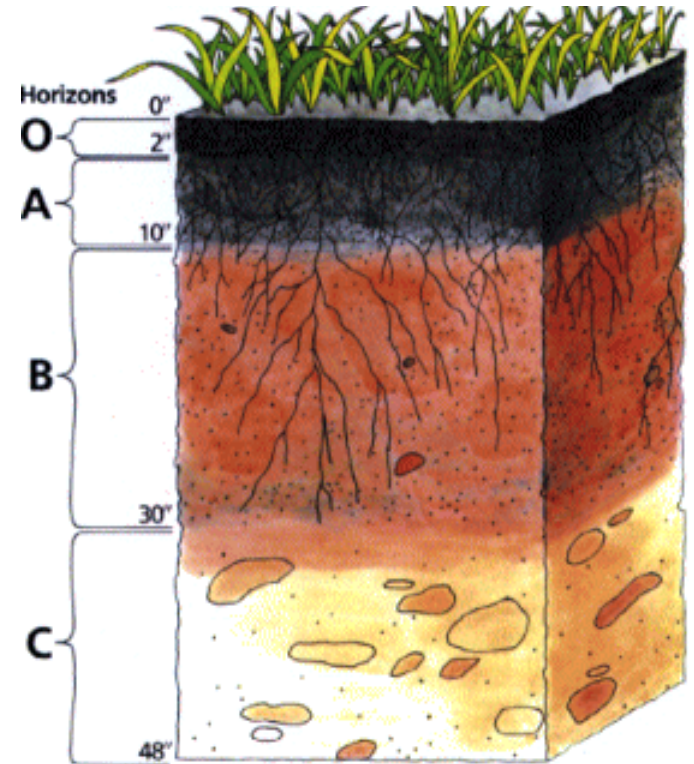
O: organic matter (dead stuff).

A: eluvial horizon, mineral matter mixed with humified (decomposed) organics.

B: illuvial horizon, concentrated clay (iron or calcium oxides).

C: weathered parent material.

R: regolith – unaltered parent material.





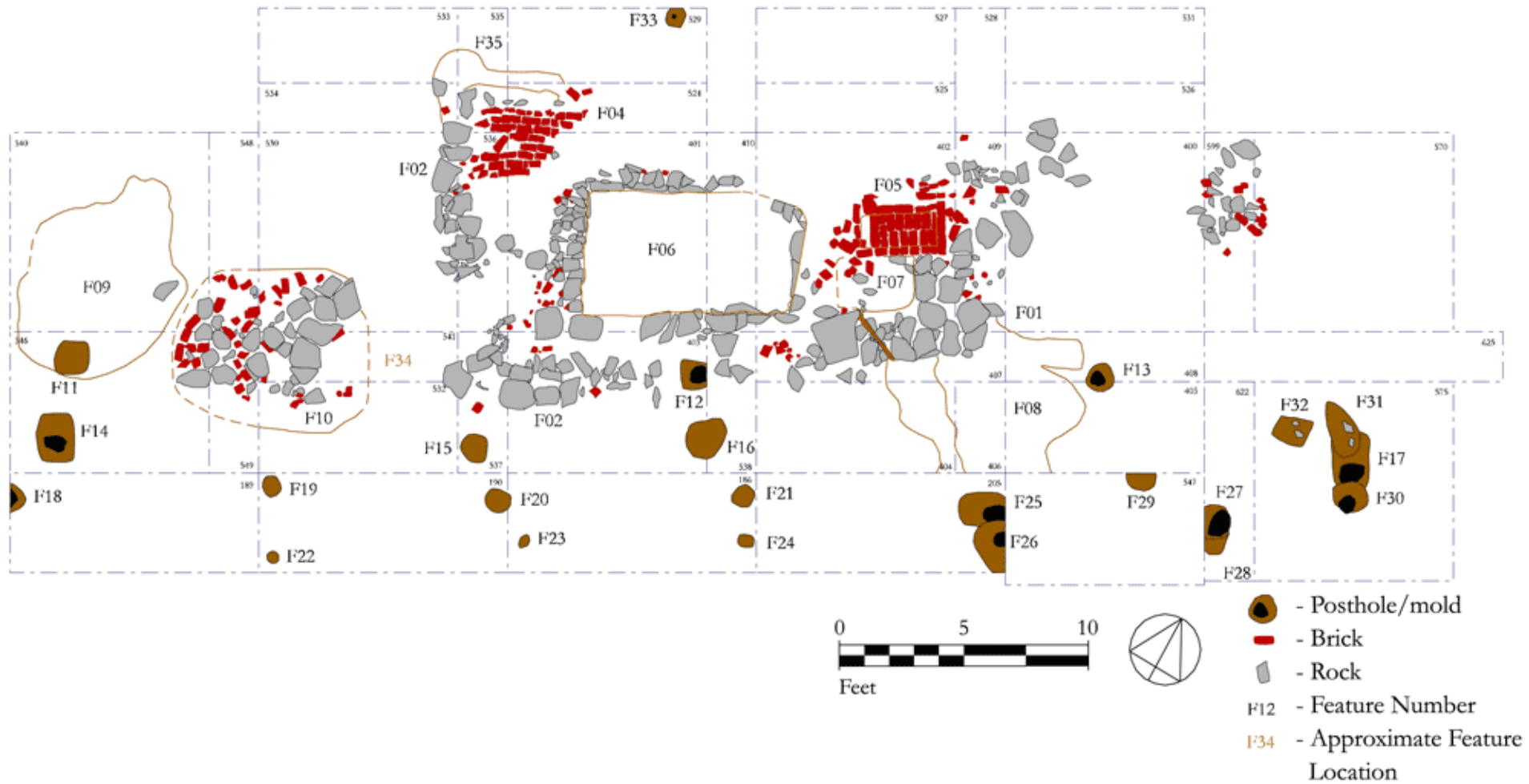


10511. THE OLD LOVIN HOUSE AT "MONTICELLO," CHARLOTTESVILLE, VA

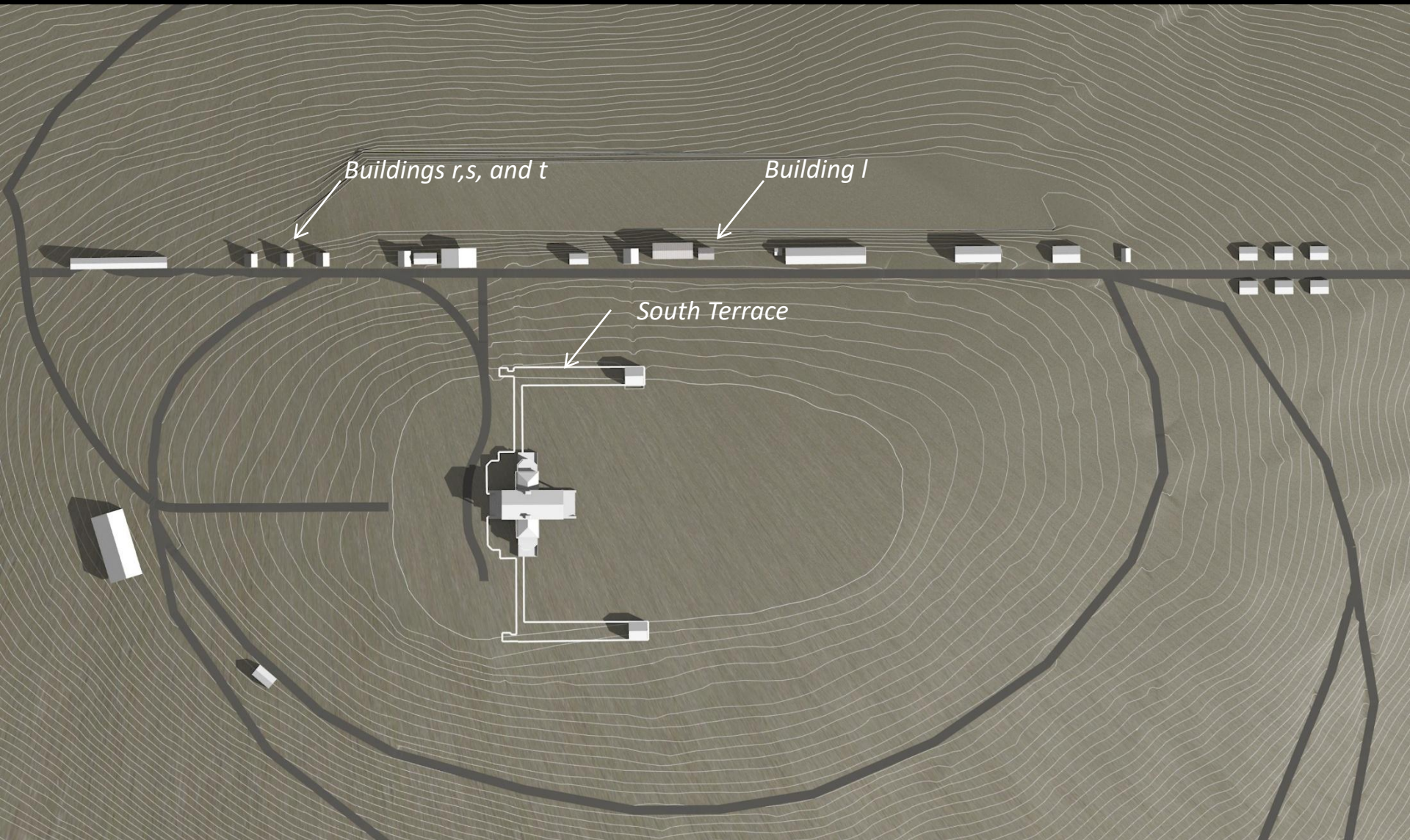




Building o, Mulberry Row

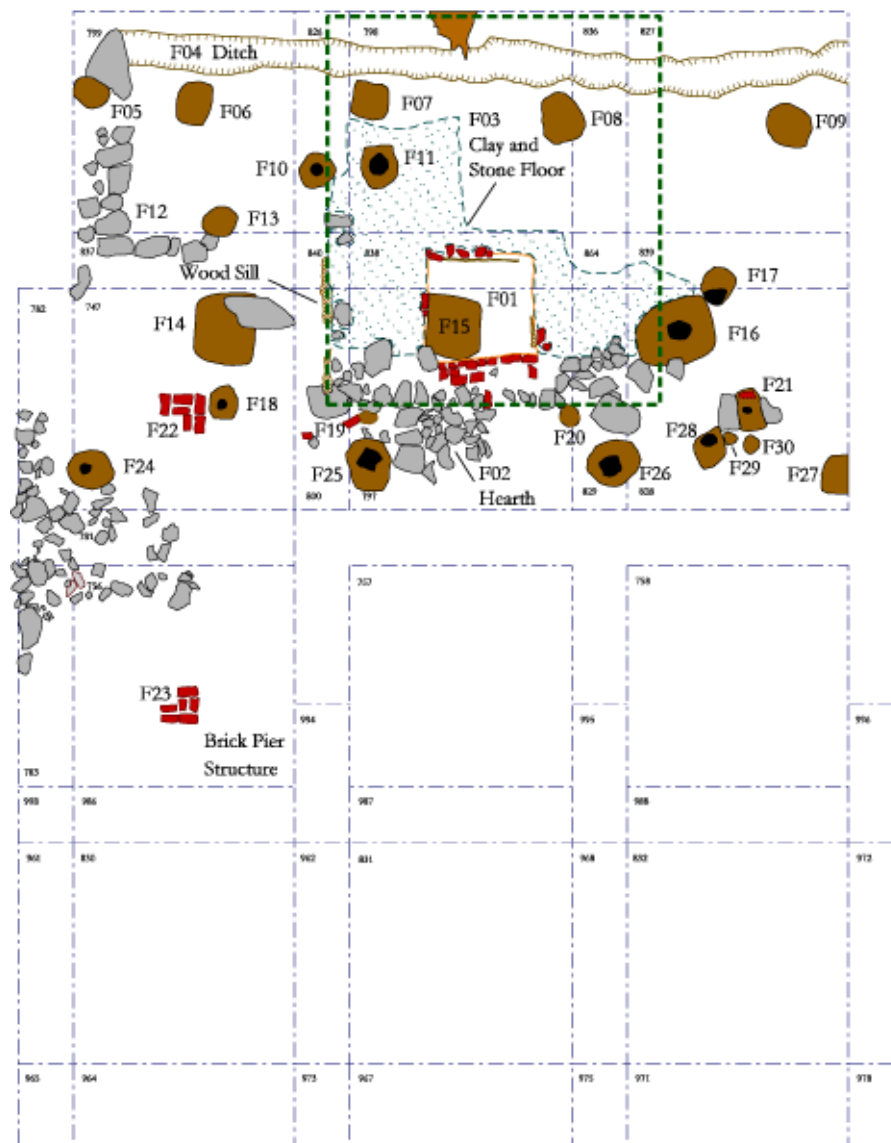


Mulberry Row, c. 1790-1809





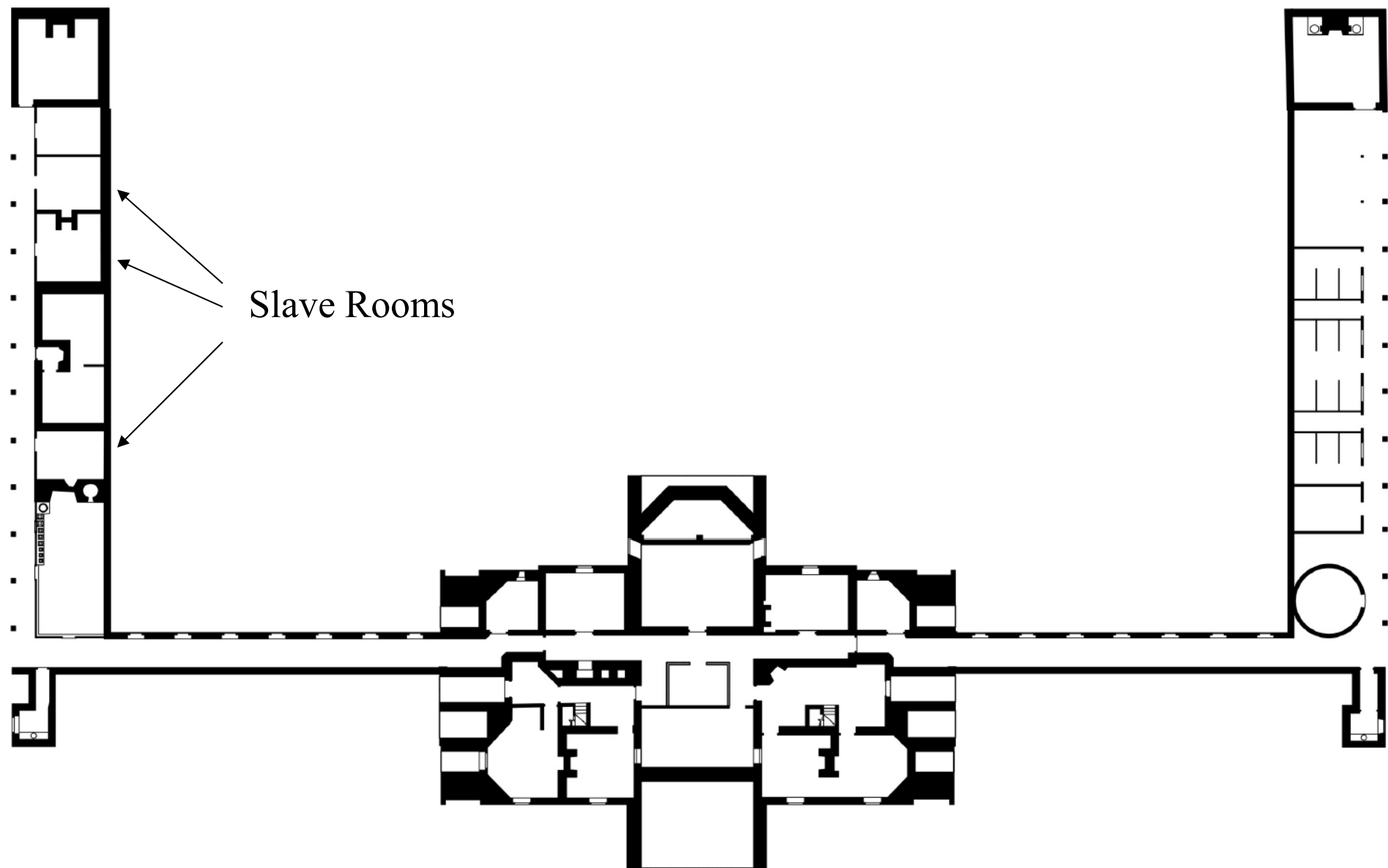
Buildings



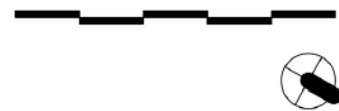
- Rock
- Brick
- Posthole
- Tree Stump
- Feature Number



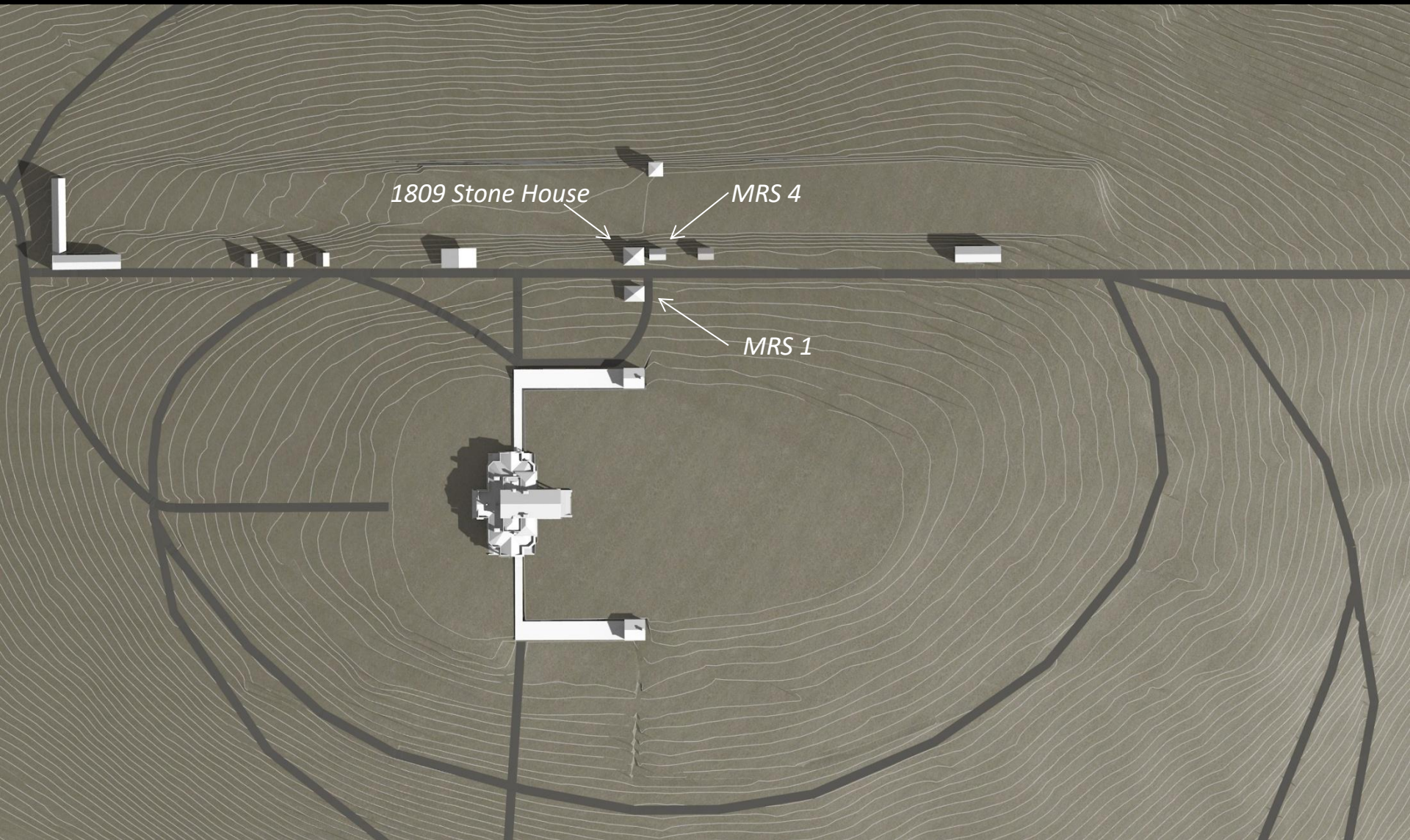




Monticello II Basement Plan

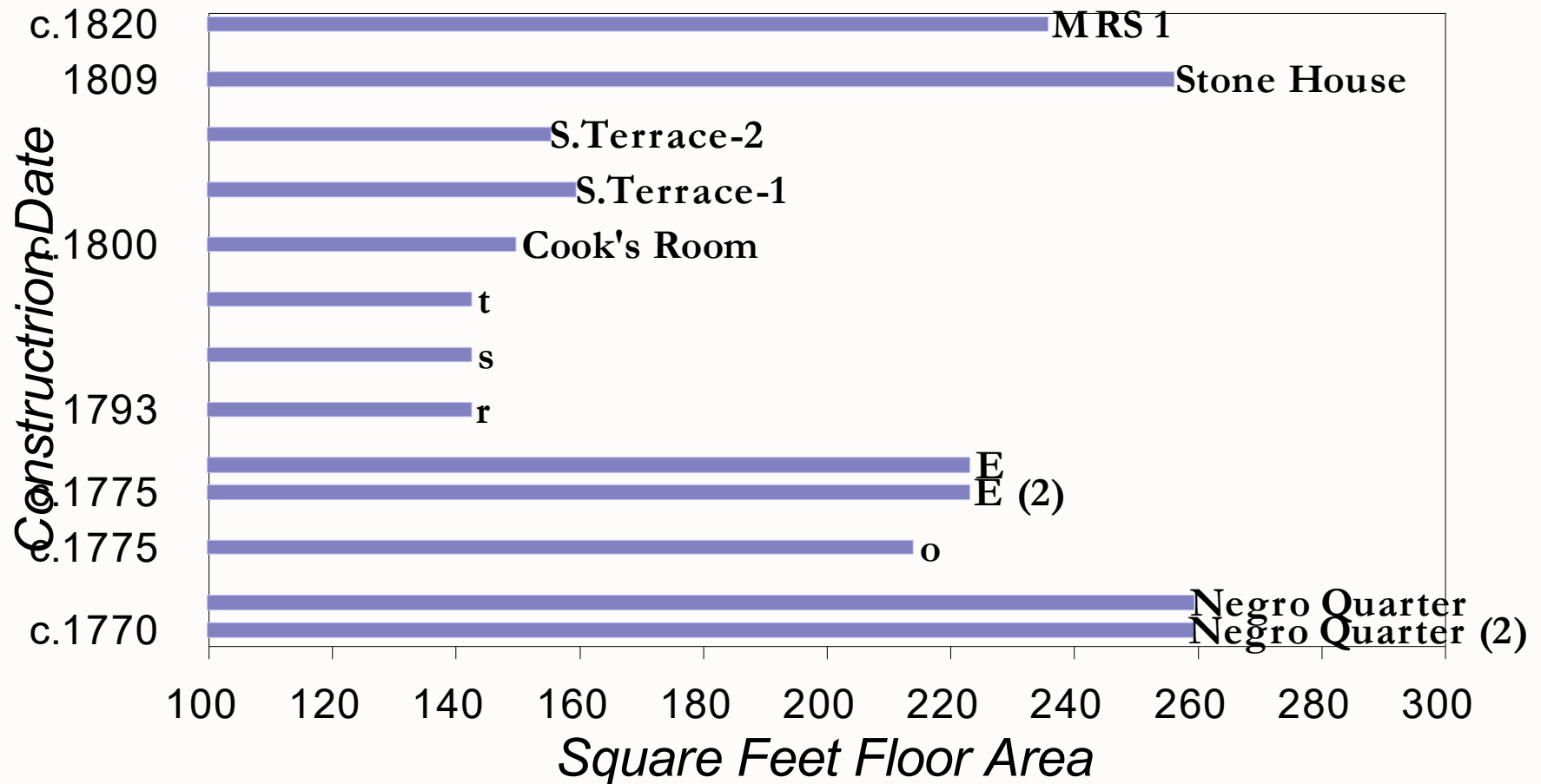


Mulberry Row, c. 1810-1830





Mulberry Row: Room Sizes





Sub-Floor Pit Hypotheses:

- Africanisms

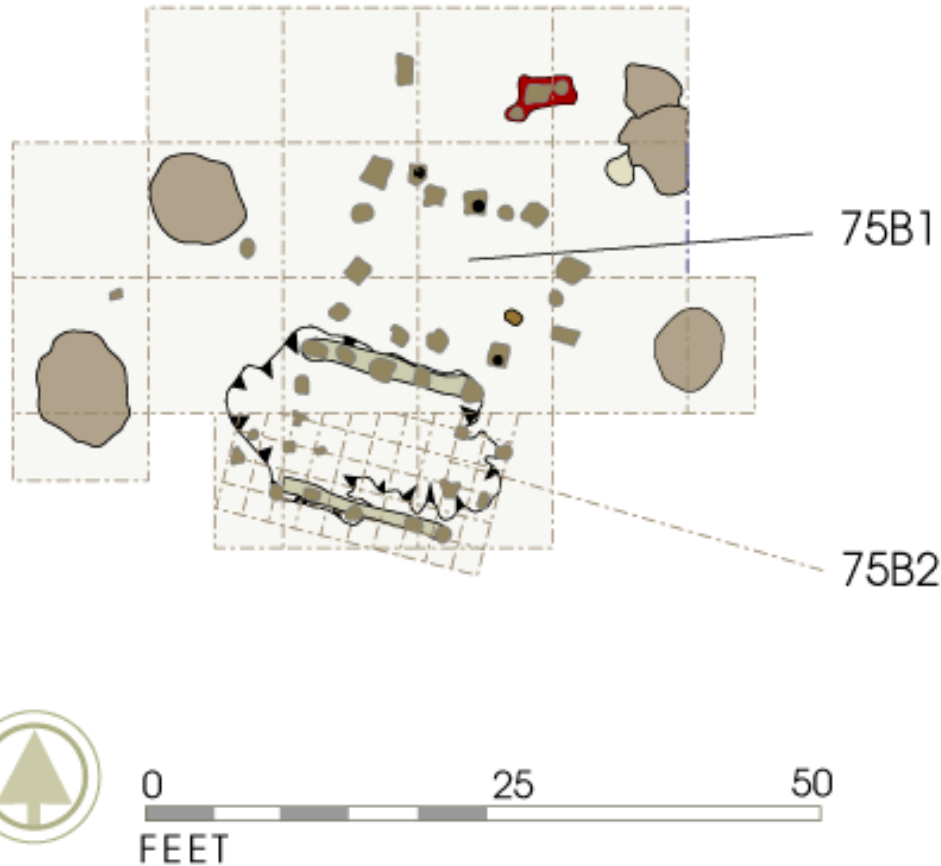


Source:

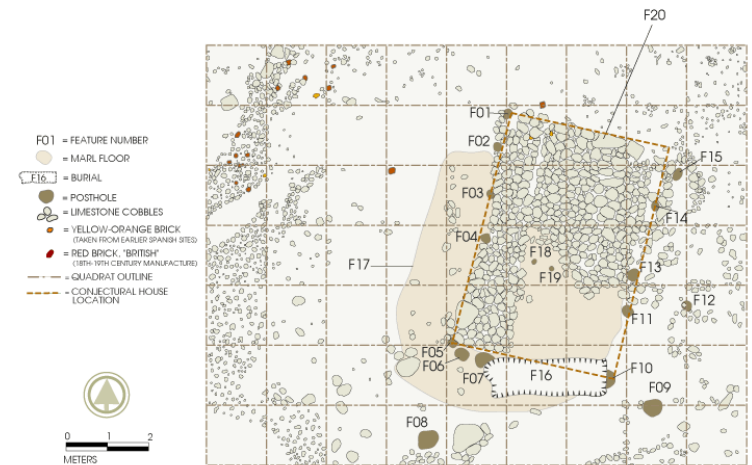
Joan Blaeu, [Atlas
major]
Geographia, quae
est Cosmographia
Blaviana . . .
Amsterdam,
1662.

Africanisms?

Yaughan Plantation, South Carolina



Seville Plantation, Jamaica



Sub-Floor Pit Hypotheses

- **Africanisms**

- **Winter Root Crop Storage**

“the way of propagating potatoes, [is to] bury them underground near the fire hearth, all the winter until the time comes that their seedlings are to be set”.

- Robert Beverly, 1705

“a large deep opening, covered with boards, which was used as a place to store sweet potatoes during the winter.”

- Booker T. Washington, c. 1860

Sub-Floor Pit Hypotheses

- Africanisms
- Winter Root Crop Storage
- Sites of Resistance

“This morning I had a complaint about a butter pot’s being taken from the dairy door where it was put to sweeten last night.... I sent Billy Beale to search all their holes and boxes; And in their loft it was found, but both of them solemnly denying that they knew anything of it”

- Landon Carter, 1770

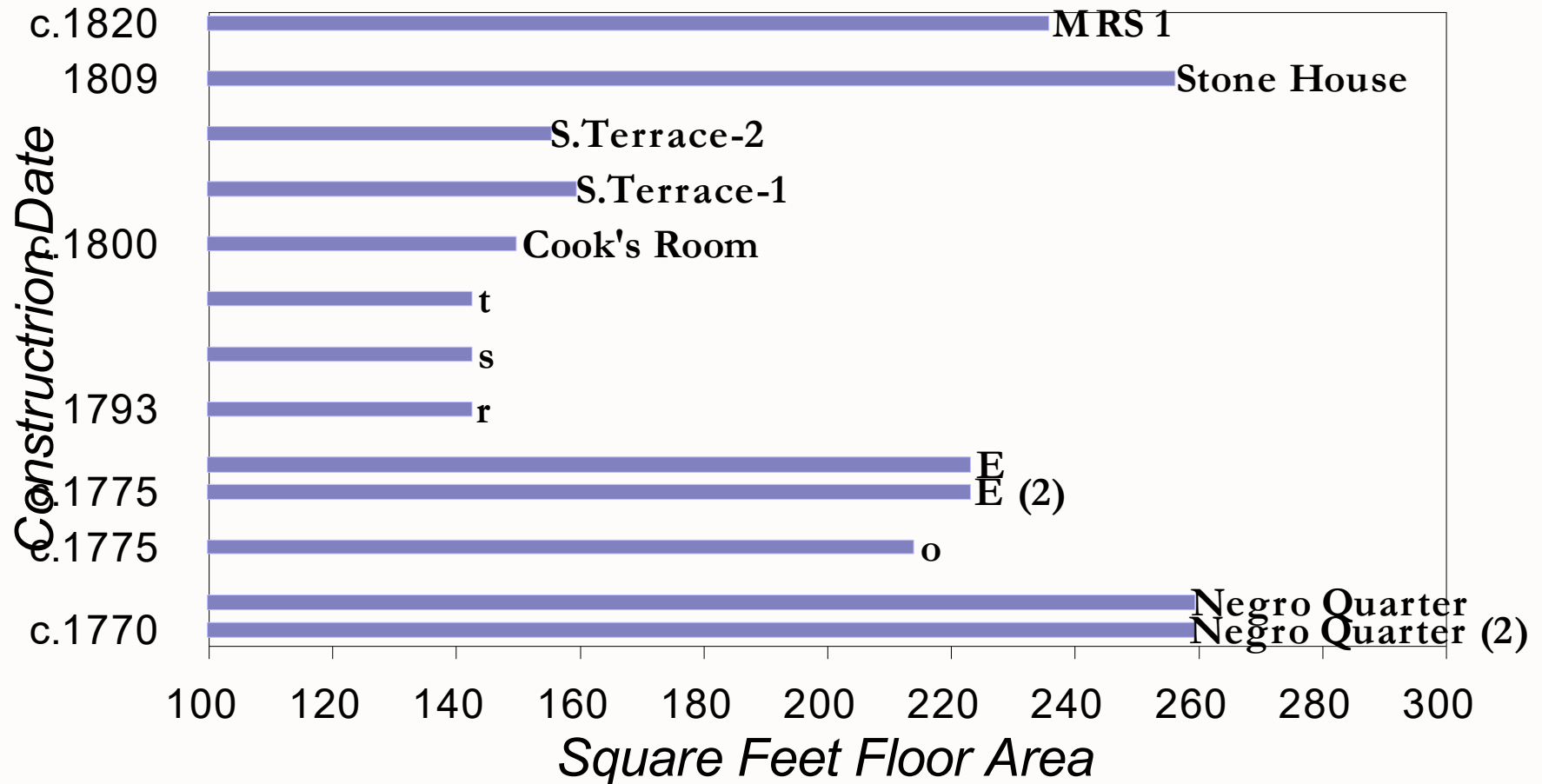


Sub-Floor Pit Hypotheses

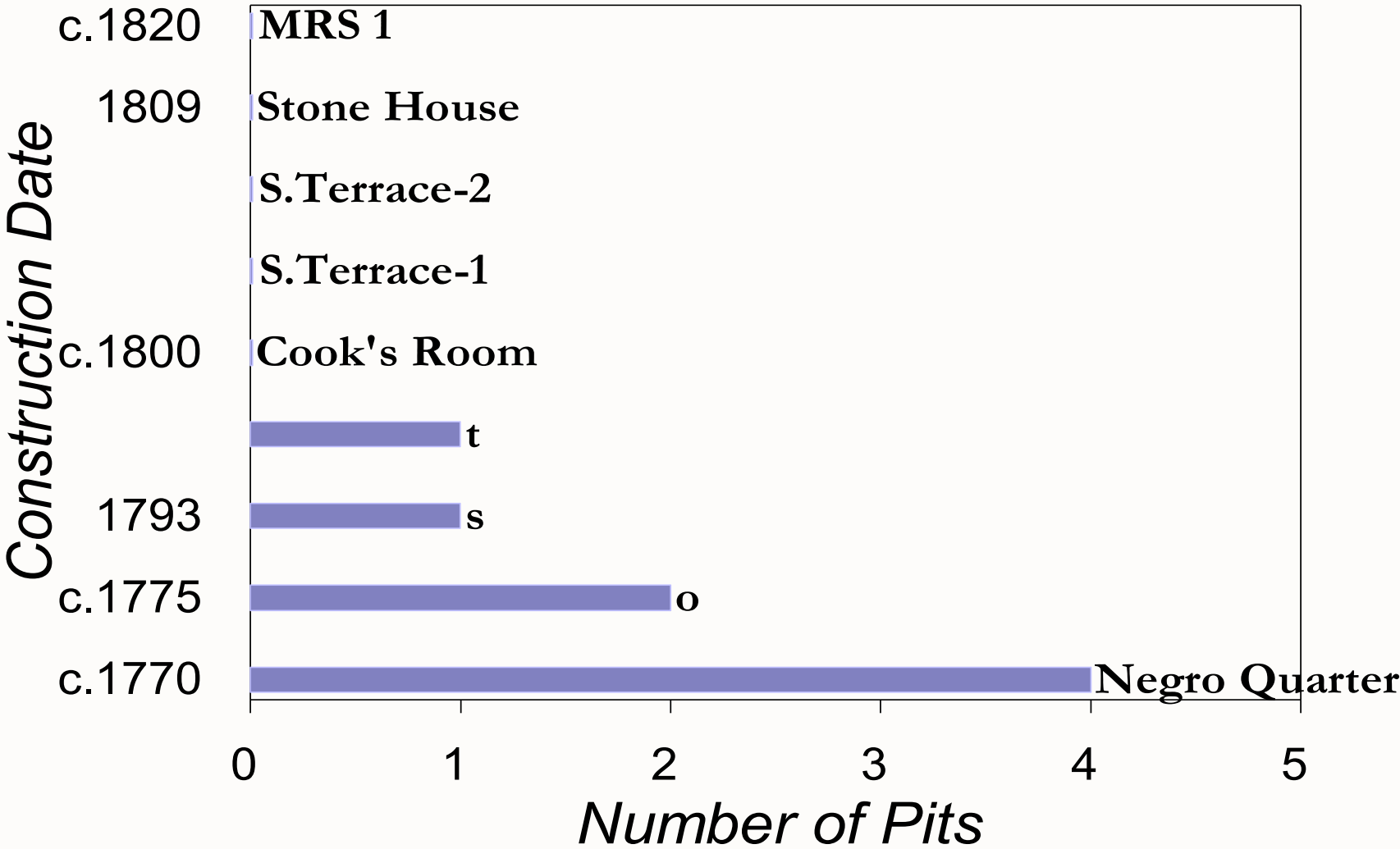
- **Africanisms**
- **Winter Root Crop Storage**
- **Sites of Resistance**
- **Safe Deposit Boxes**



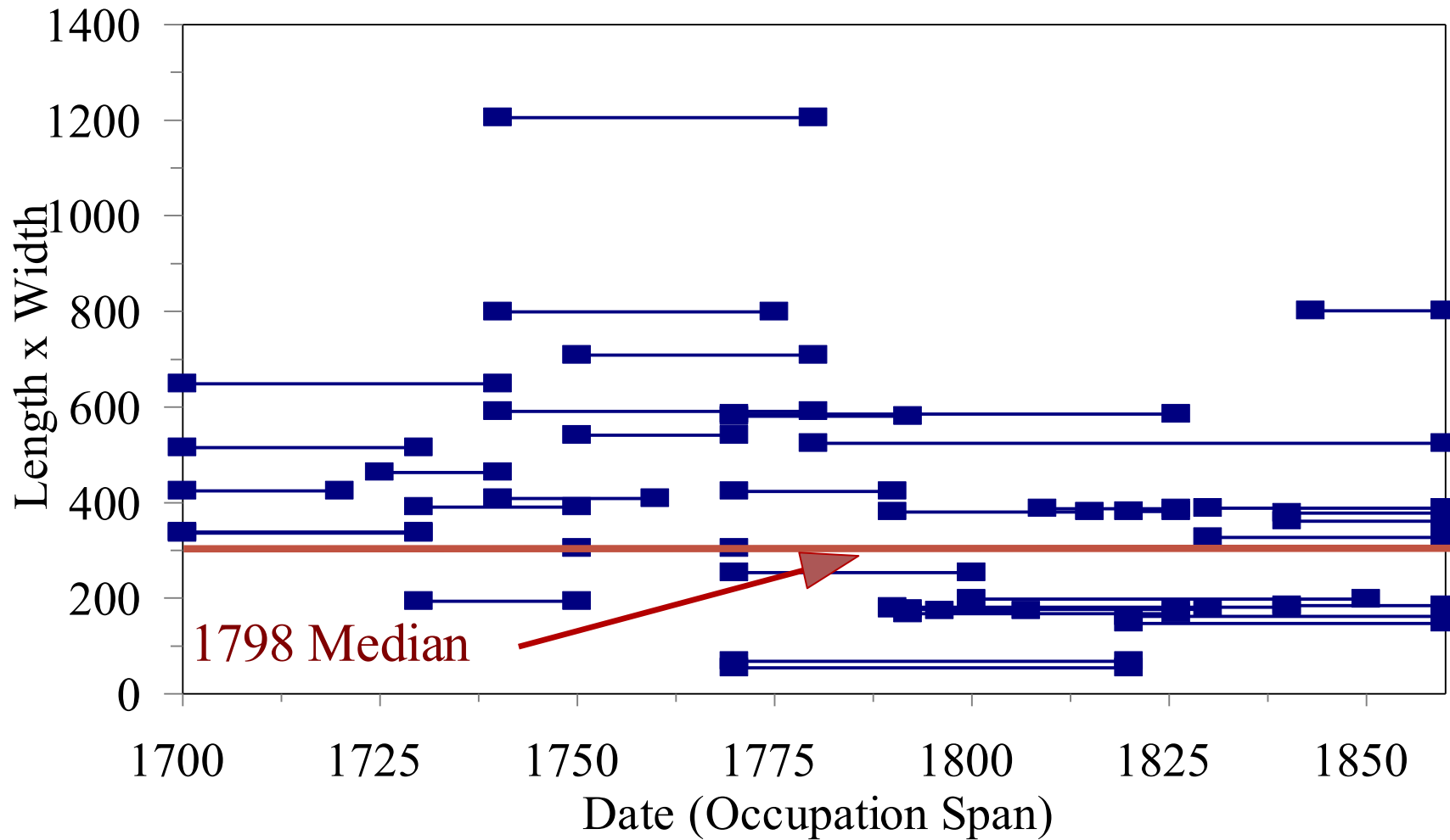
Mulberry Row: Room Sizes



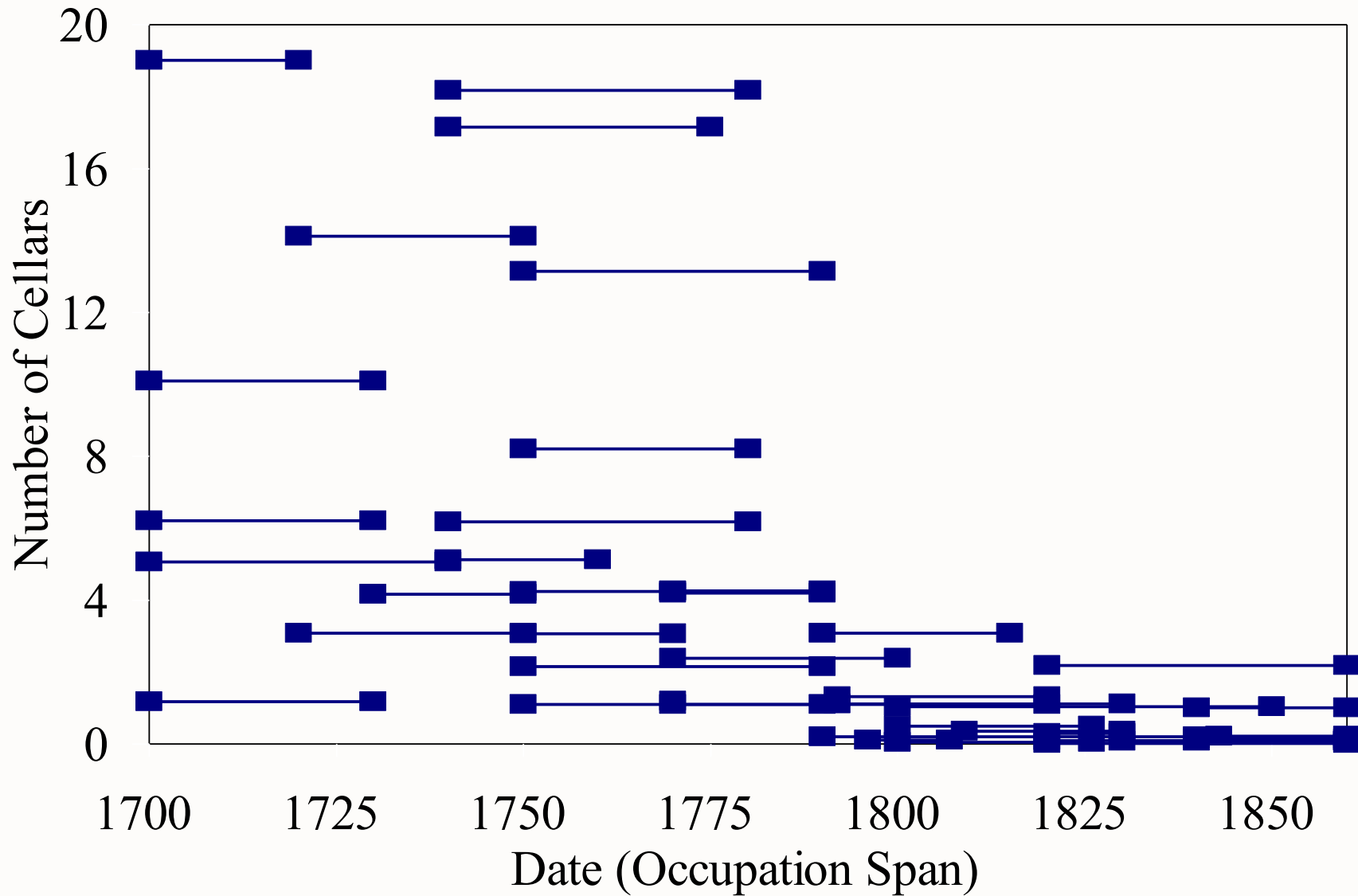
Mulberry Row: Number of Subfloor Pits



Virginia Slave Quarters: House Size



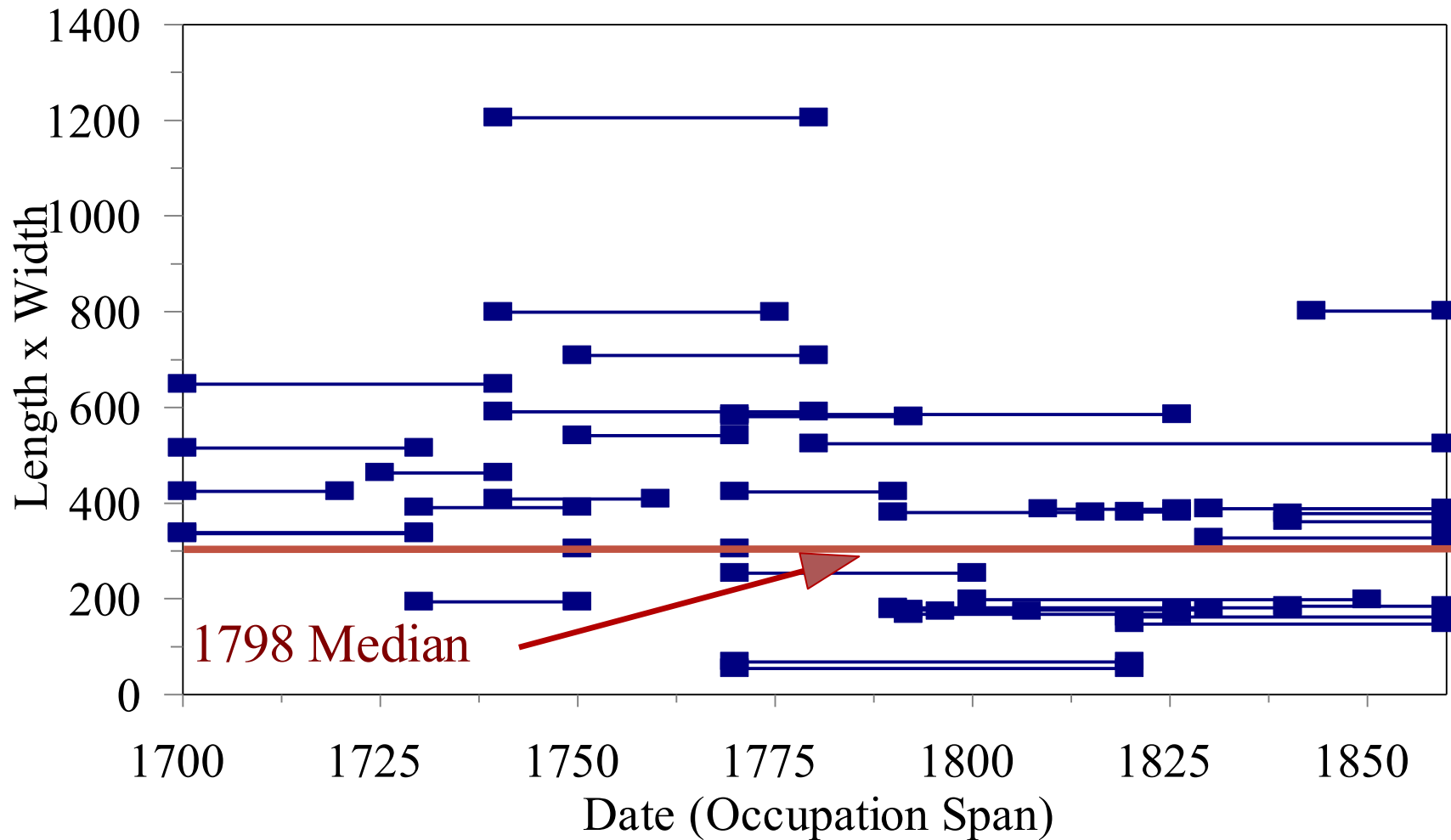
Virginia Slave Quarters: Subfloor Pits





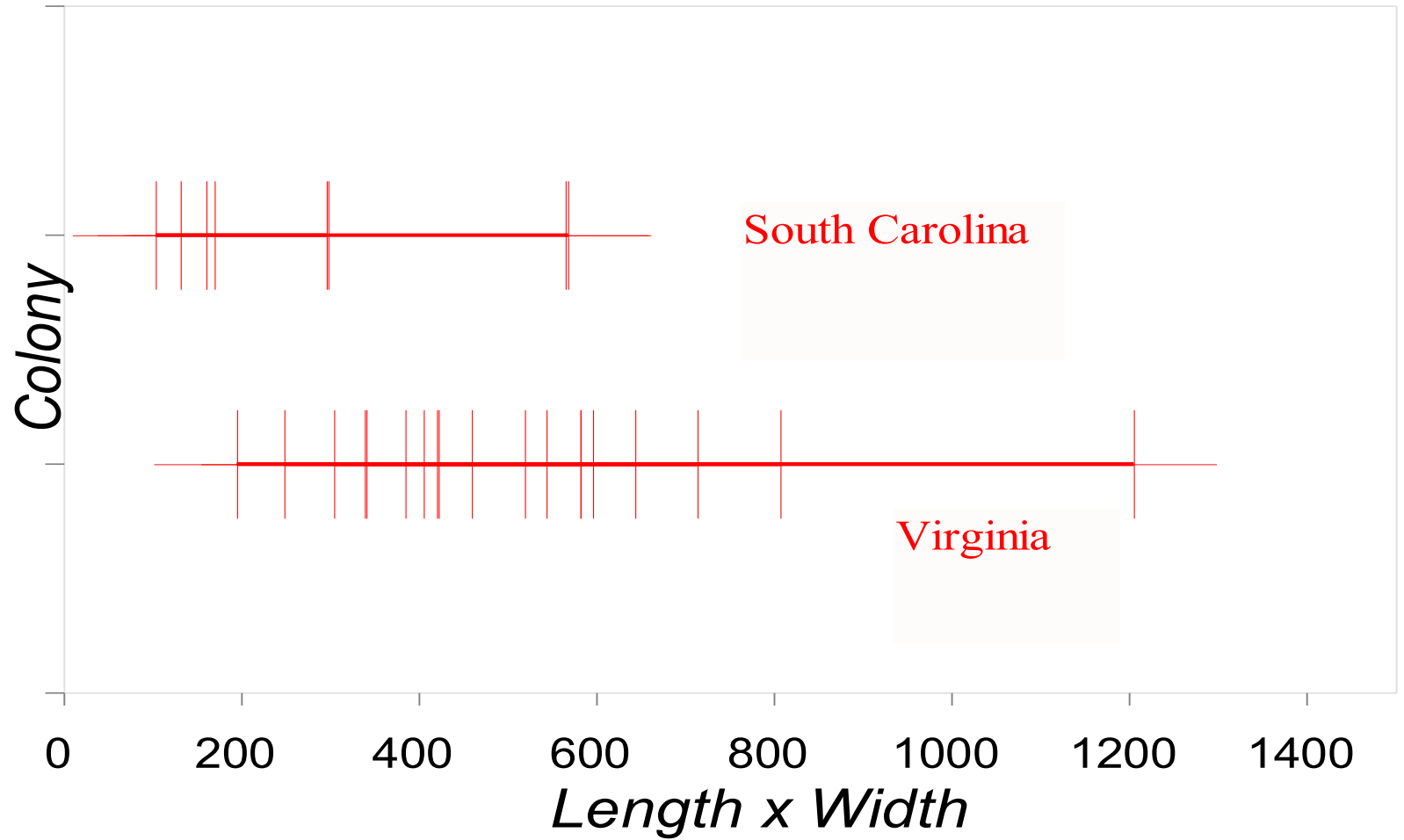


Virginia Slave Quarters: House Size





Slave Quarters: House Size



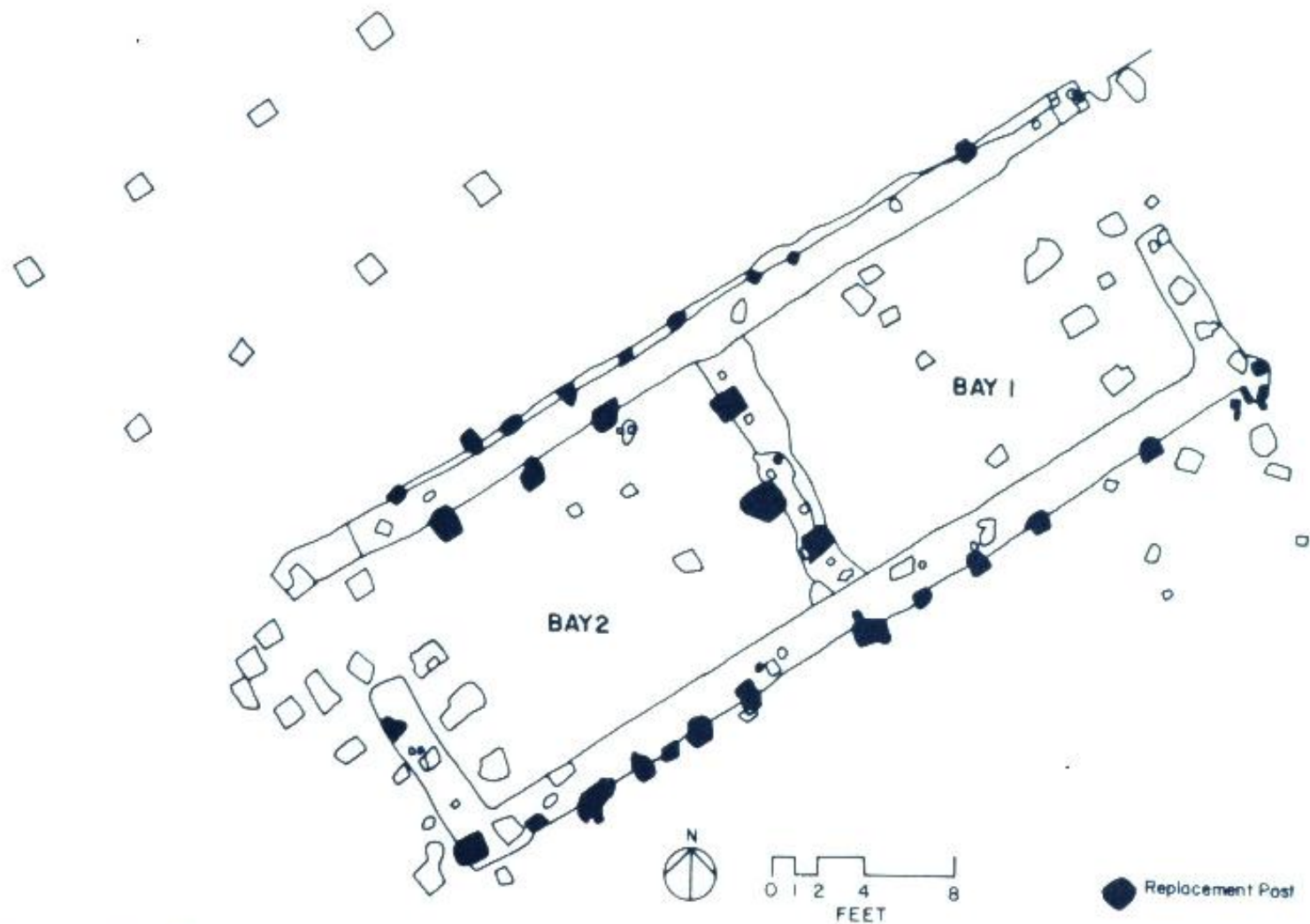
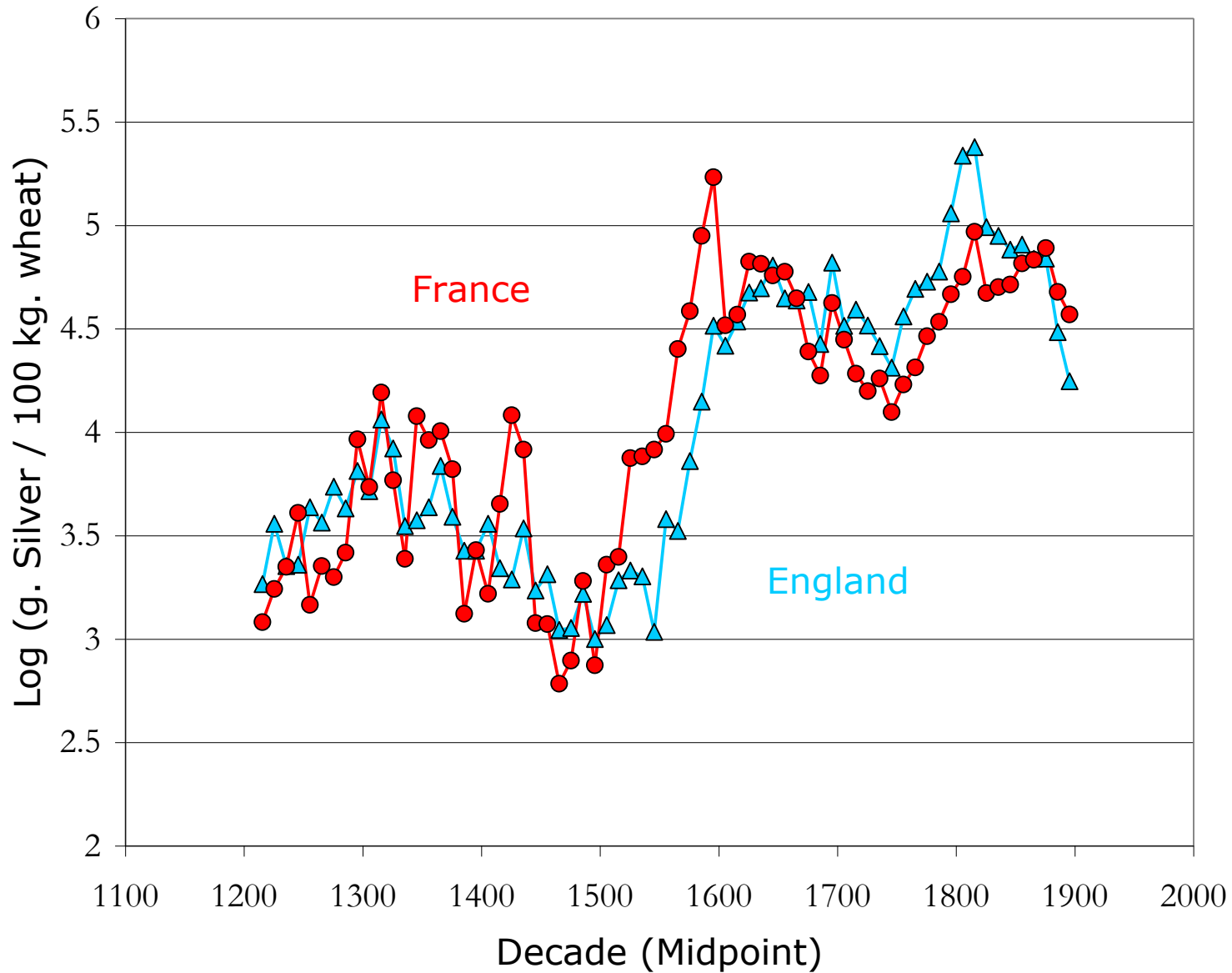


Figure 46. Foundation plan of a clay-walled house showing replacement posts; also shows adjacent structure. Curriboo Plantation, Berkeley County, South Carolina (adapted from Wheaton et al. 1983:169).

European Wheat Prices



*“There is reason to expect a rupture has taken place between Spain and England. If so, it will involve France and so render the present war of Europe almost universal there. I hope they will see it their interest to let us make bread for them in peace, and to give us a good price for it. **We have every moral certainty that wheat will be high for years to come. I cannot therefore, my dear Sir, omit to press, for myself, the going into that culture as much as you think practicable. In Albemarle I presume we may lay aside tobacco entirely; and in Bedford the more we can lay it aside, the happier I shall be.**”*

Thomas Jefferson to Nicholas Lewis
July 4, 1790



Tobacco

- Hoes
- Stumps
- Field rotation
- Long fallows for sustainability
- Locally evolved
- ***Gang labor***



Wheat

- Plows
- No stumps!
- Permanent fields
- Crop rotations and fertilizers for sustainability.
- Carts, livestock
- Mills
- Blacksmiths
- European handbooks
- **Spatially dispersed task groups**

"I rode afterwards to see my pea gatherers and found, notwithstanding, my 11 hay gathers were put to assist them, there were only 27 people. 6 were sick. 3 were finishing scaffolding the tobacco, 3 with Manuel clearing the grass before his plow. 2 filling up the tobacco house floor; and 3 nay 4 Suckering and topping. Thus it is and has been, at no other work can the hands be kept together but at the hoe."

Landon Carter, 1770

"I told him [Phil Hubbard] that if he and Hanner did make up a match I would give them a pot and house..."

Jeremiah Goodman to TJ, 1814



Some Questions

- Physical traces of changing agricultural work routines: hoes to plows?
- Physical traces of shift in agricultural ecology: swidden plots to permanent fields
- Change in settlement patterns: locations of slave houses on the landscape, relative to overseer's houses?
- Shifts in household organization and household economies?
- Changes in assemblage content: participation in market and the "consumer revolution"?